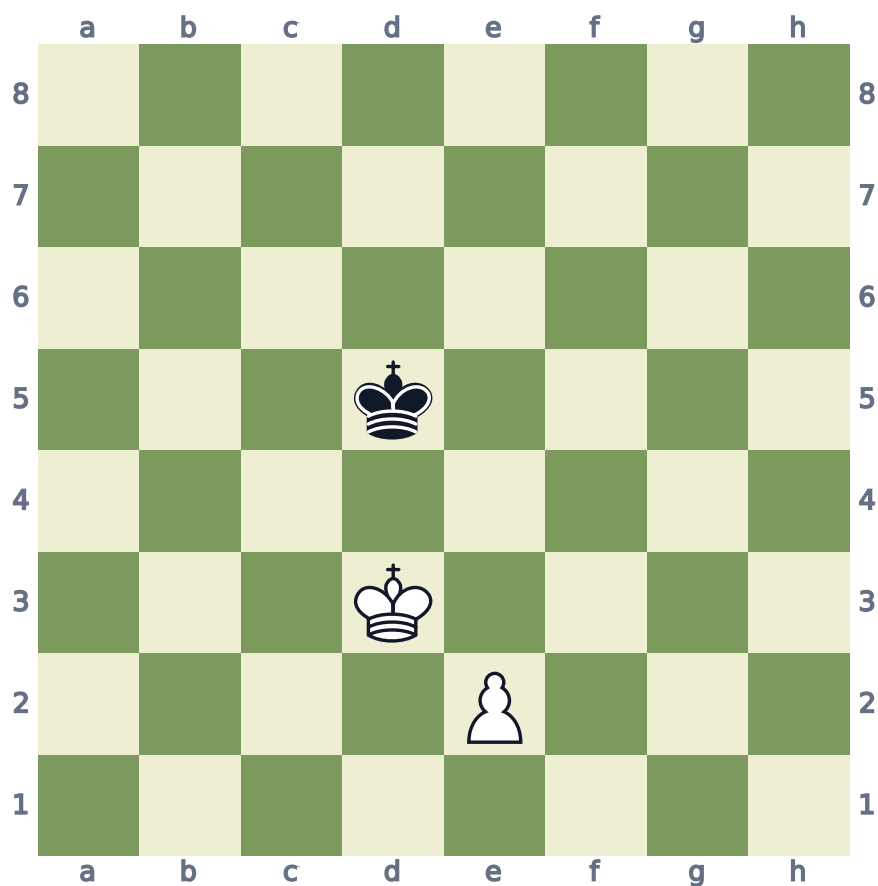


Essential Endgame Position Workbook

Exact positions, practical defenses, and repeatable technique



Master essential endgame mechanisms by solving positions from both sides, calculating races completely, and distinguishing exact rules from useful guidelines.

32 practice units | separated solutions | scoring | review plan

ORIENTATION

How to get real improvement from this course

PURPOSE

Master essential endgame mechanisms by solving positions from both sides, calculating races completely, and distinguishing exact rules from useful guidelines.

TRAINING RULES

- Count pawn races to the promotion move, including checks and captures on the way.
- Name the target position - key square, opposition, bridge, checking distance, or blockade.
- Play every technical position from both sides against Fritz after solving it on paper.
- Do not simplify into a pawn ending without calculating it to a stable result.
-

COURSE SIZE

This PDF contains 32 practice units. Problems appear before their solutions whenever practical. Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days.

SCORING

What a complete answer contains

RECOGNITION

Name the tactical or strategic feature without assuming that the familiar pattern works.

CANDIDATES

List serious forcing and improving choices before analyzing deeply.

BEST RESISTANCE

Calculate the opponent's least cooperative legal response.

ENDPOINT

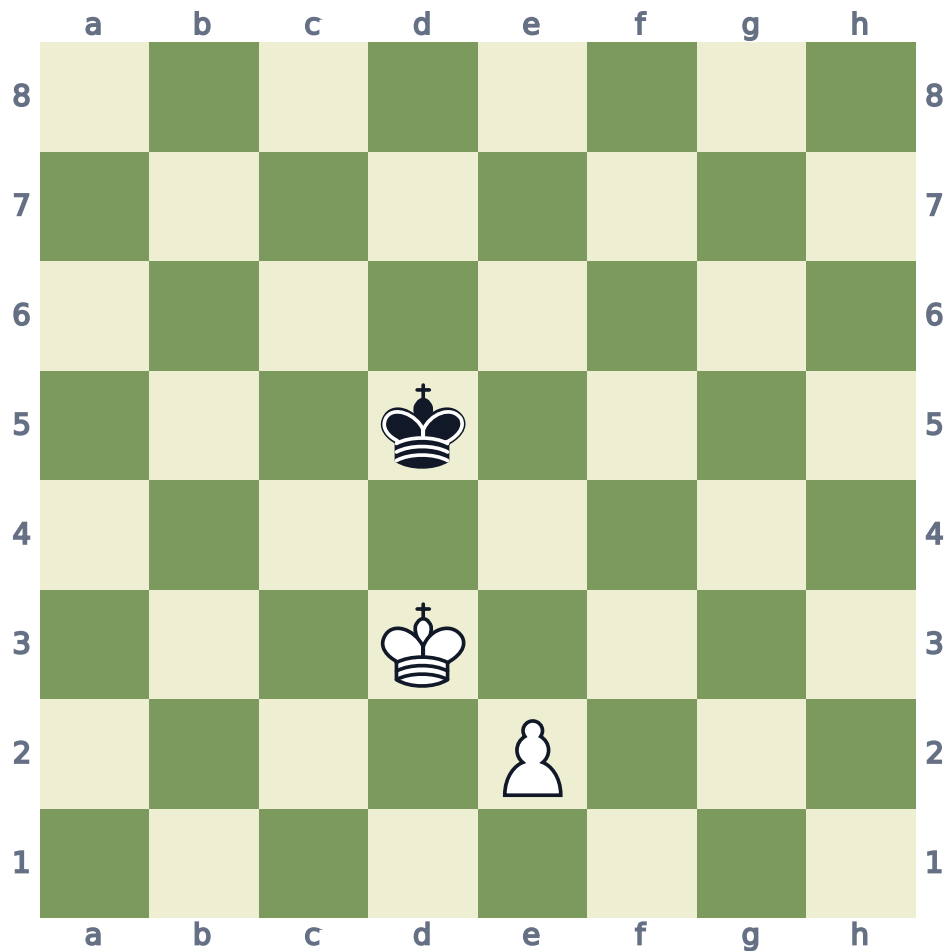
Stop only after forcing play settles, then evaluate material, kings, activity, and structure.

TRANSFER

State the visible cue that should make you remember this position during a game.

PROBLEM 01 OF 32

King and pawn: key squares



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

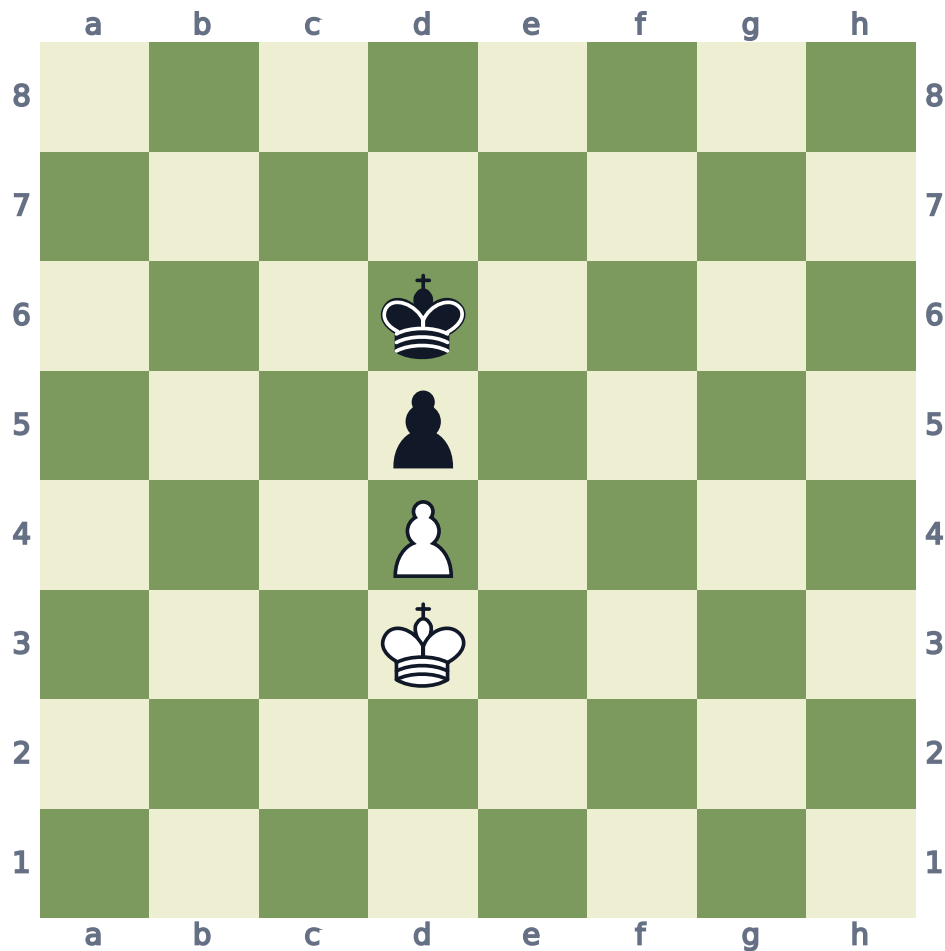
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 02 OF 32

Direct opposition

**YOUR TASK**

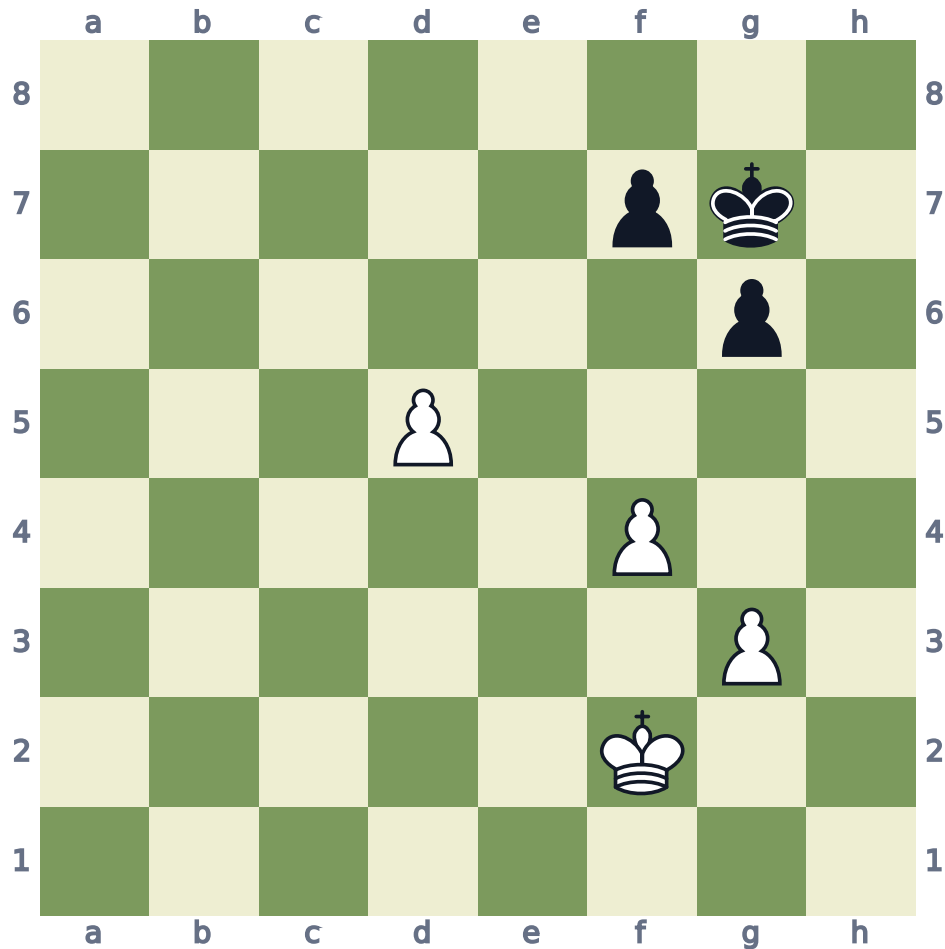
Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY**Foundation****BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION**

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 03 OF 32

Outside passed pawn



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

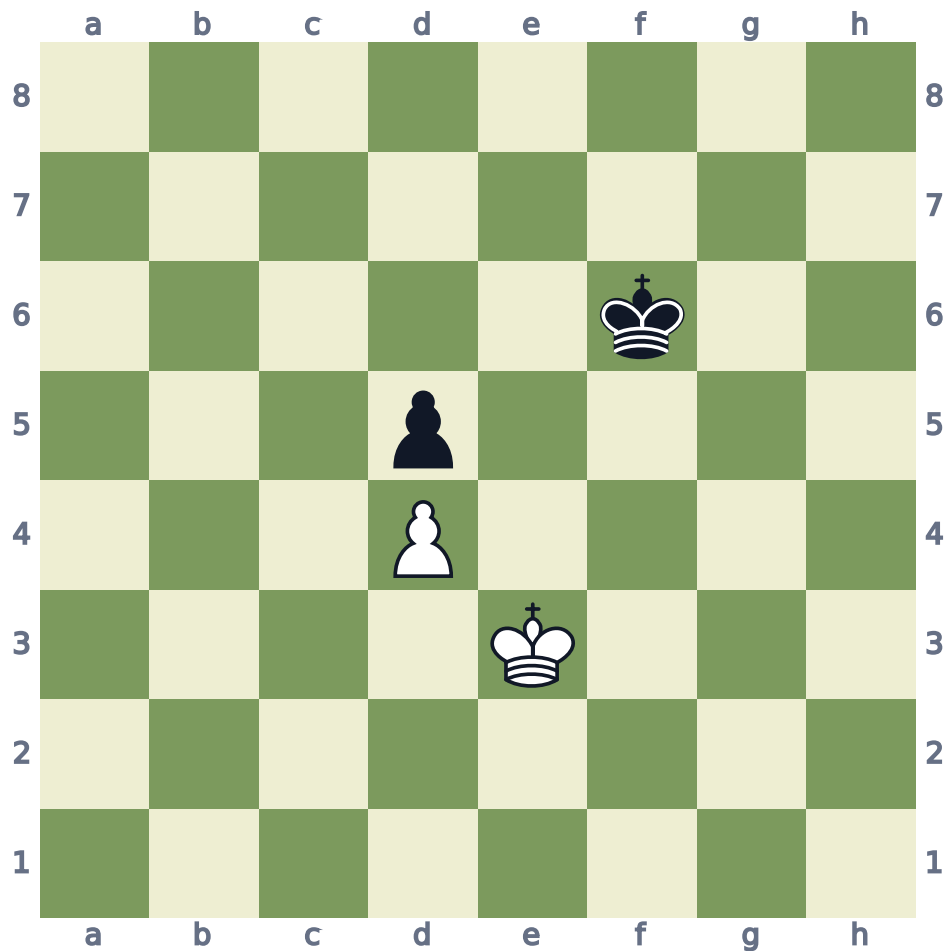
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 04 OF 32

Reserve tempo



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

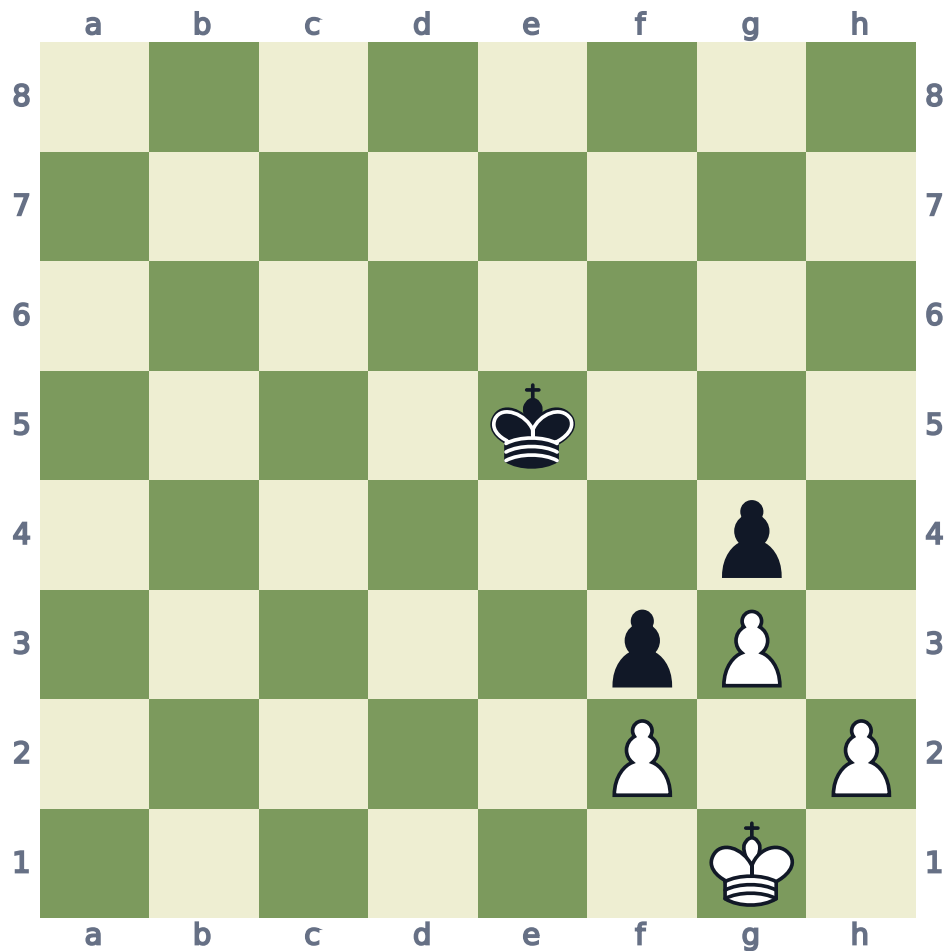
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 05 OF 32

Pawn breakthrough



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

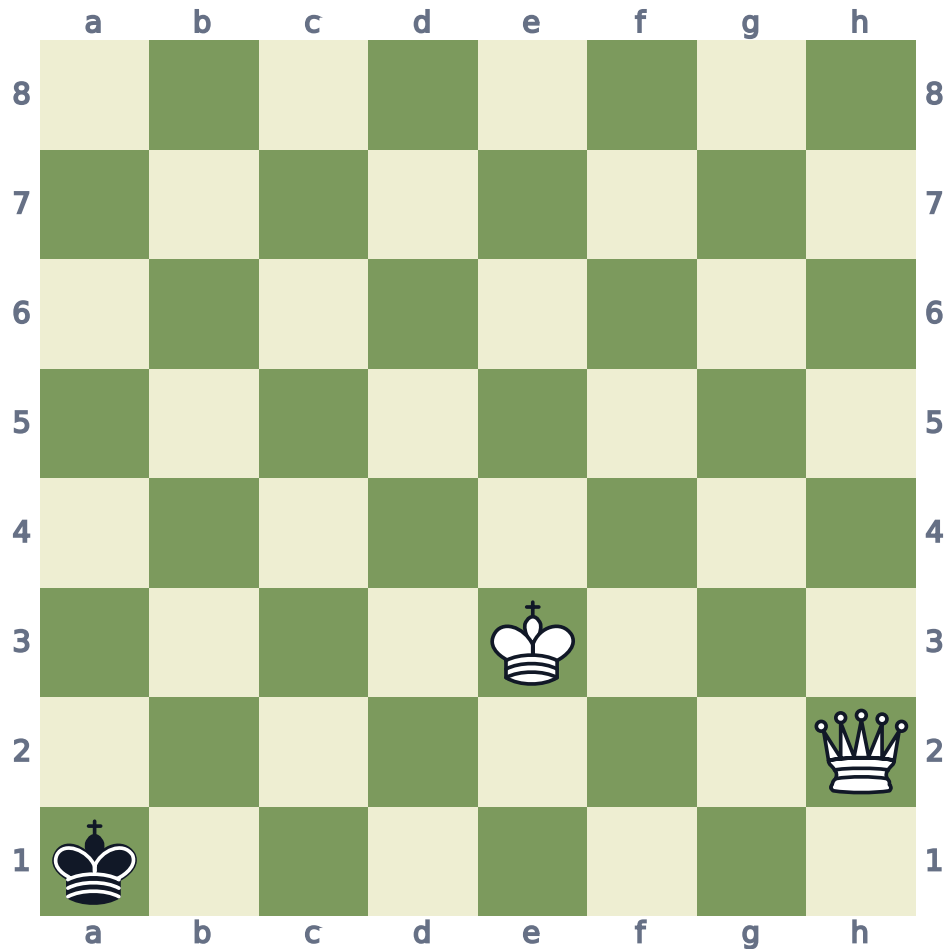
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 06 OF 32

Queen mate technique



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

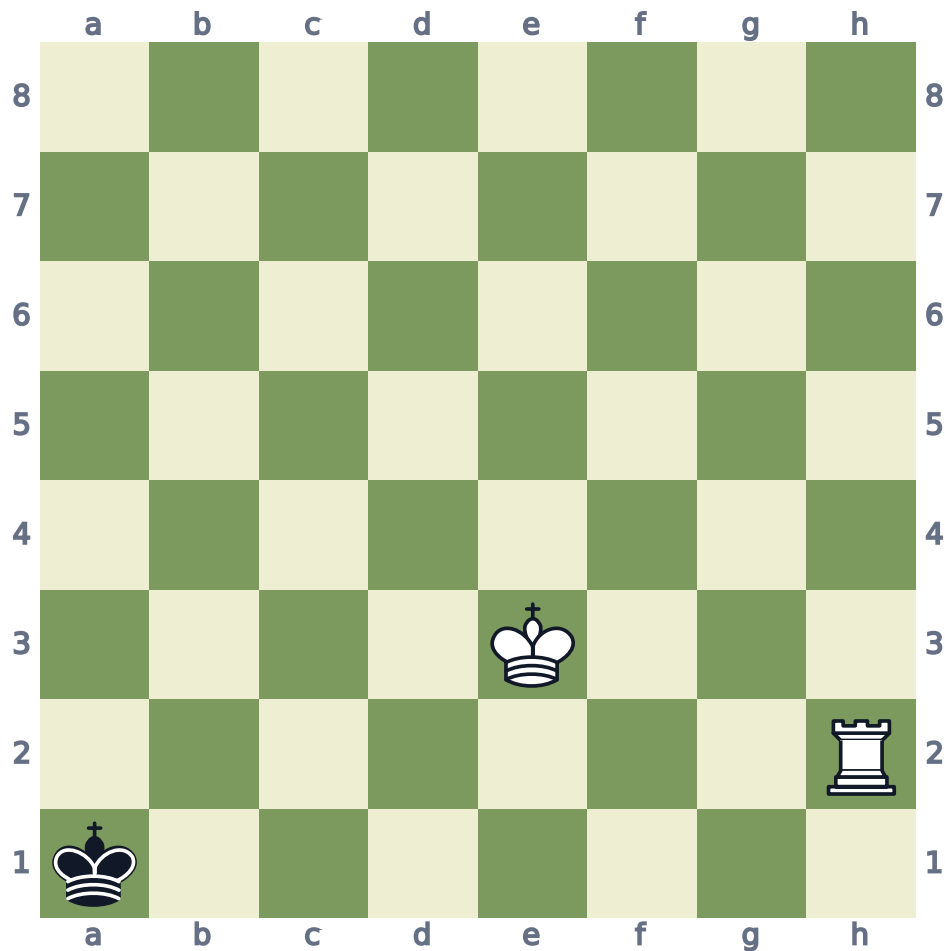
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 07 OF 32

Rook mate technique

**YOUR TASK**

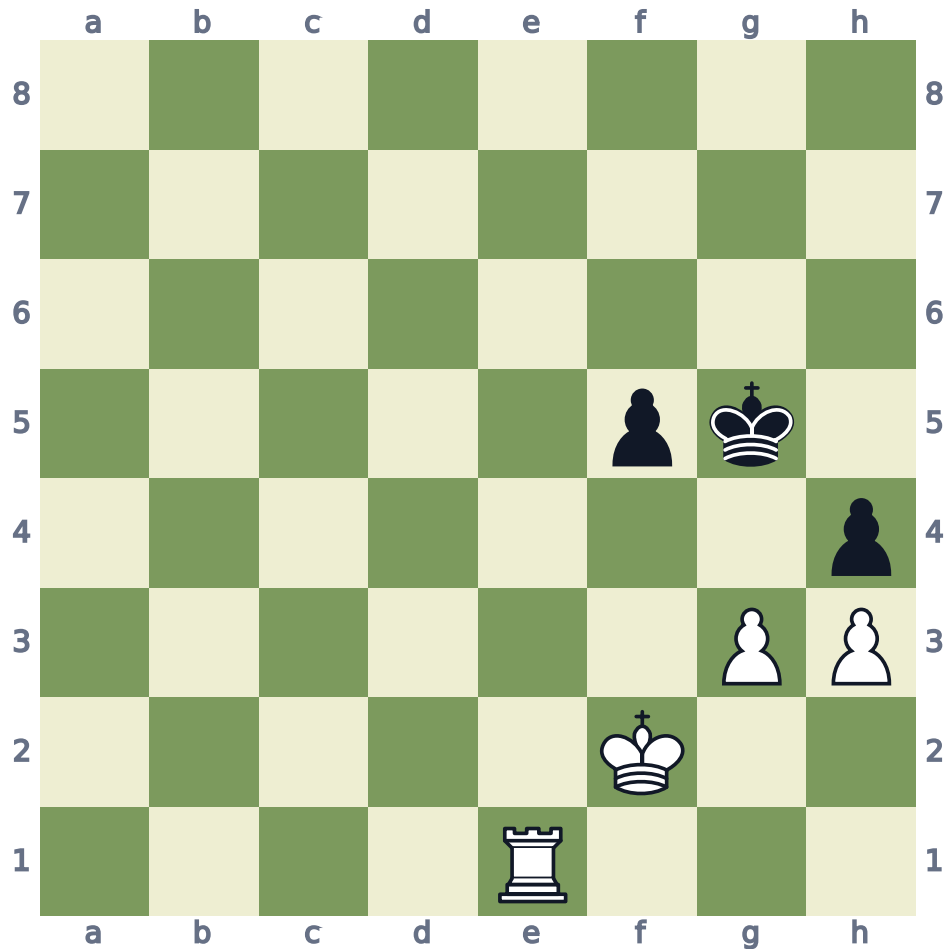
Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY**Foundation****BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION**

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 08 OF 32

Rook activity



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

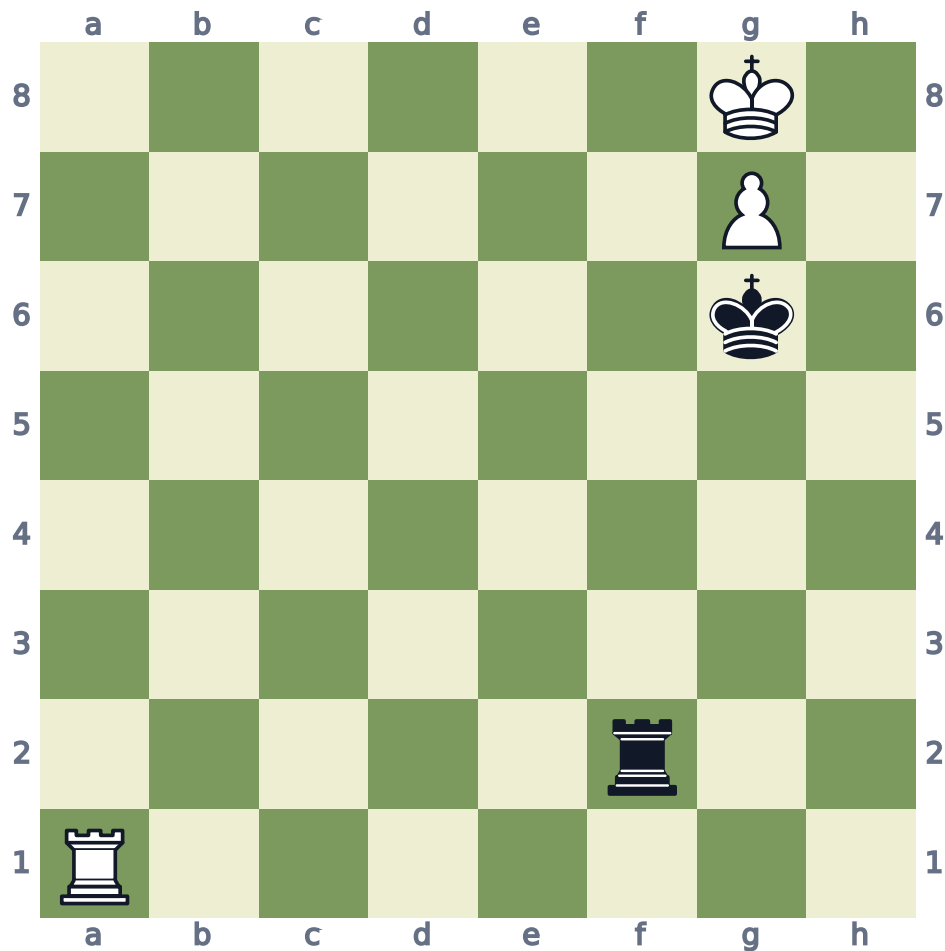
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 09 OF 32

Lucena bridge



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

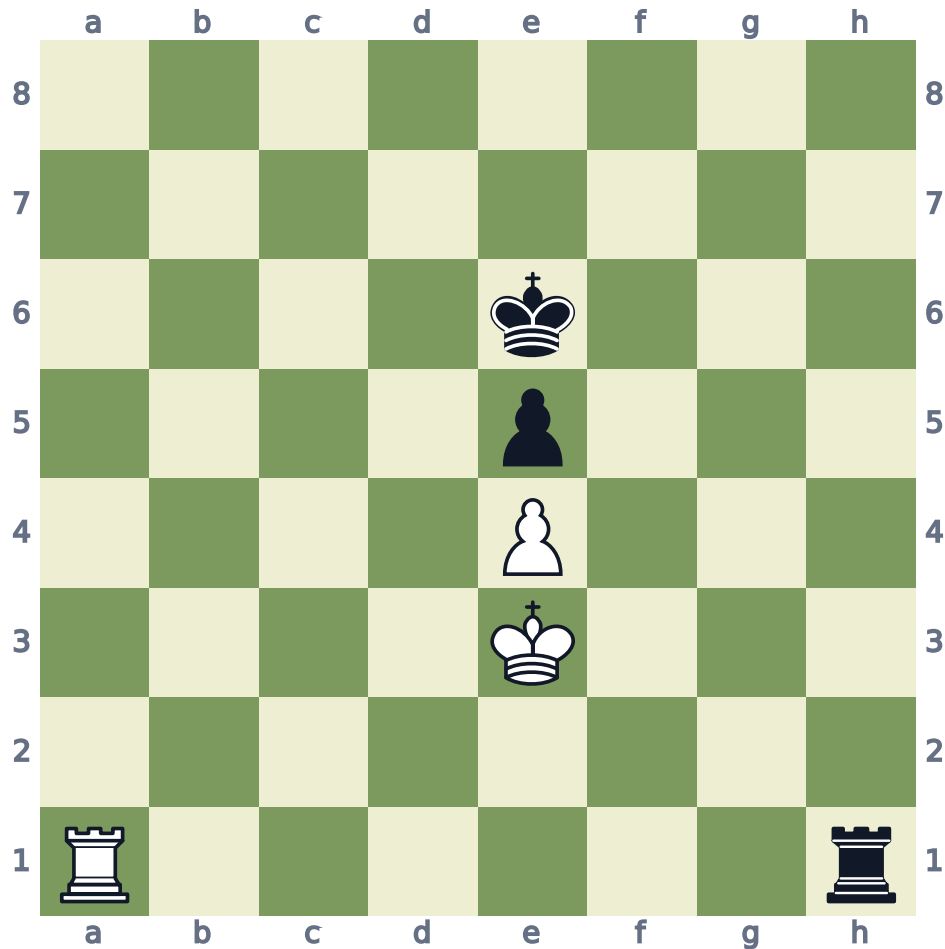
Practical

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 10 OF 32

Rook checks from behind



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

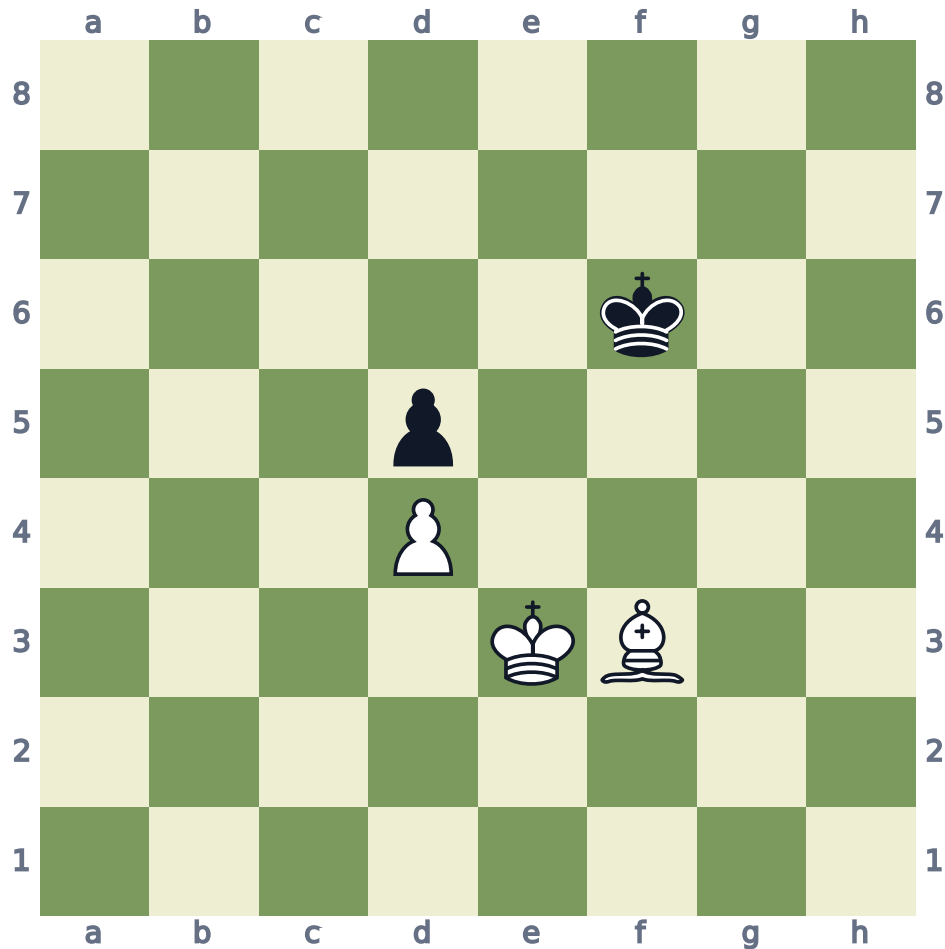
Practical

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 11 OF 32

Bishop against pawns



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

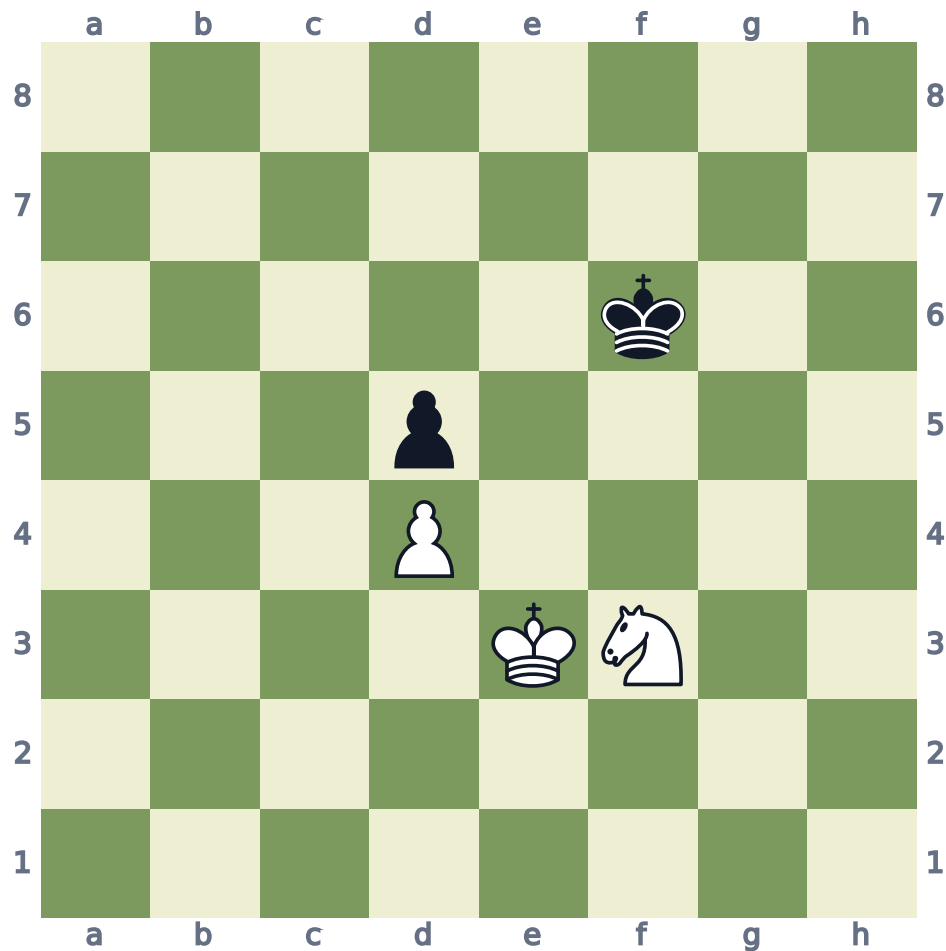
Practical

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 12 OF 32

Knight against pawns



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

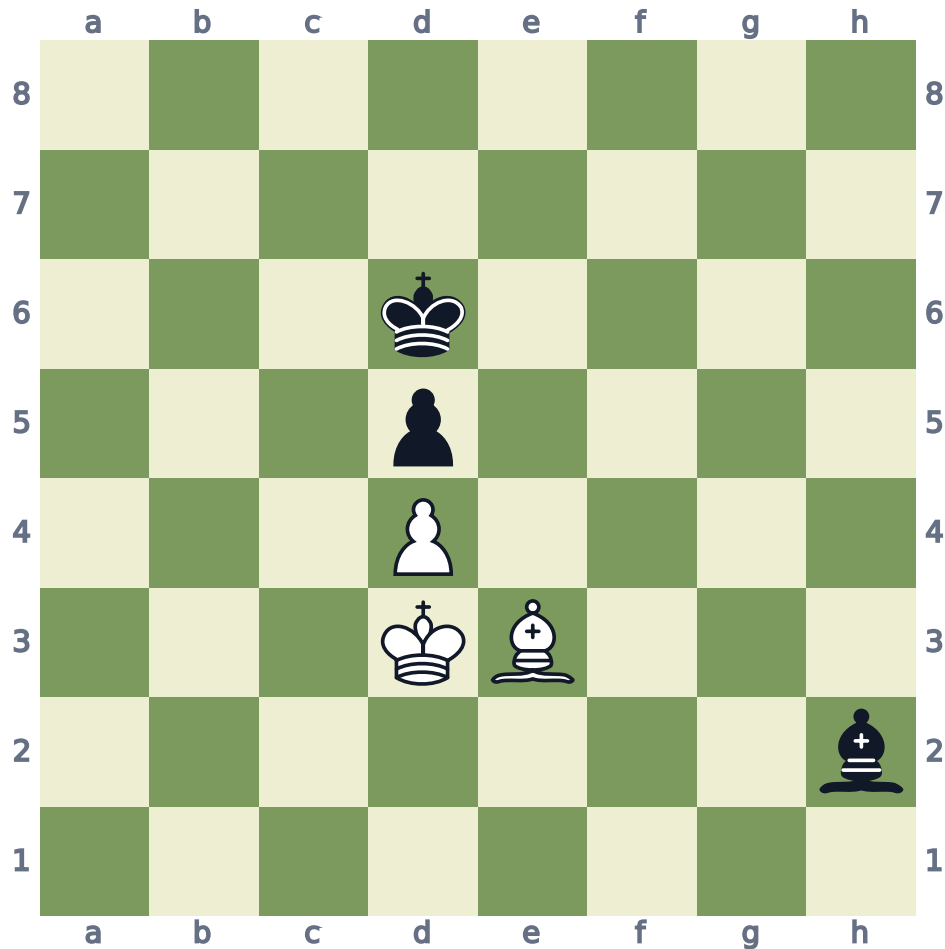
Practical

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 13 OF 32

Opposite-colored bishops



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

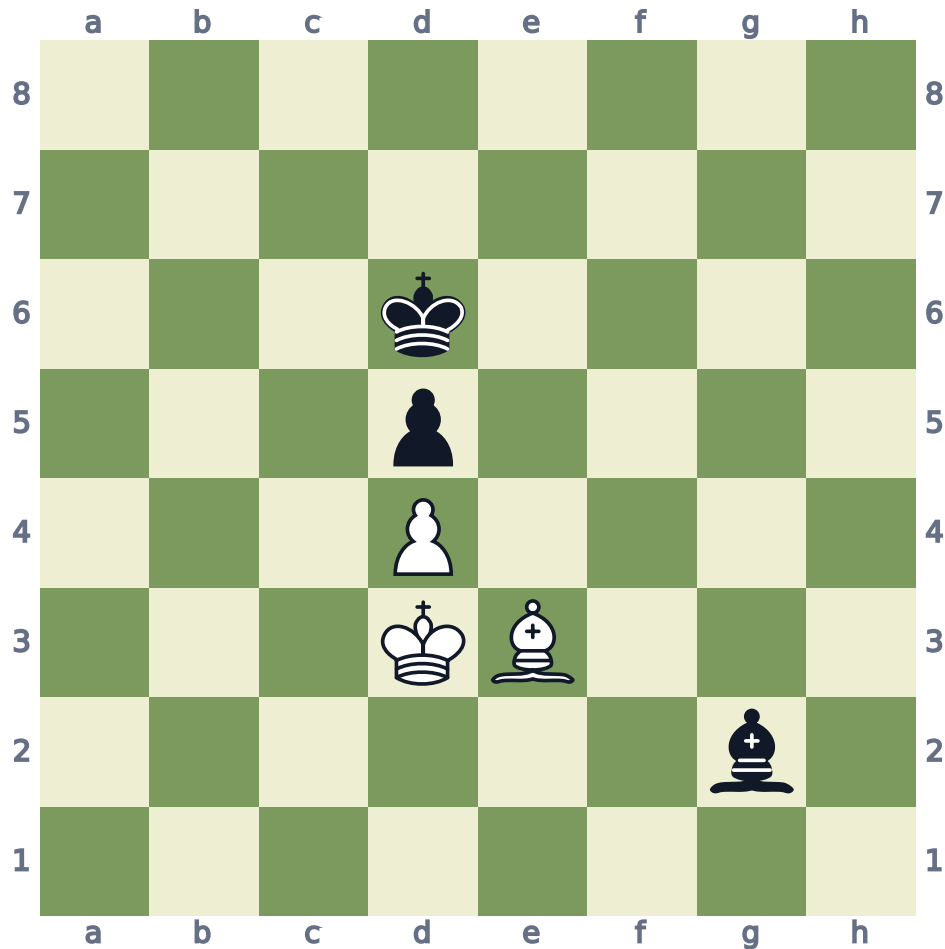
Practical

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 14 OF 32

Same-colored bishops



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

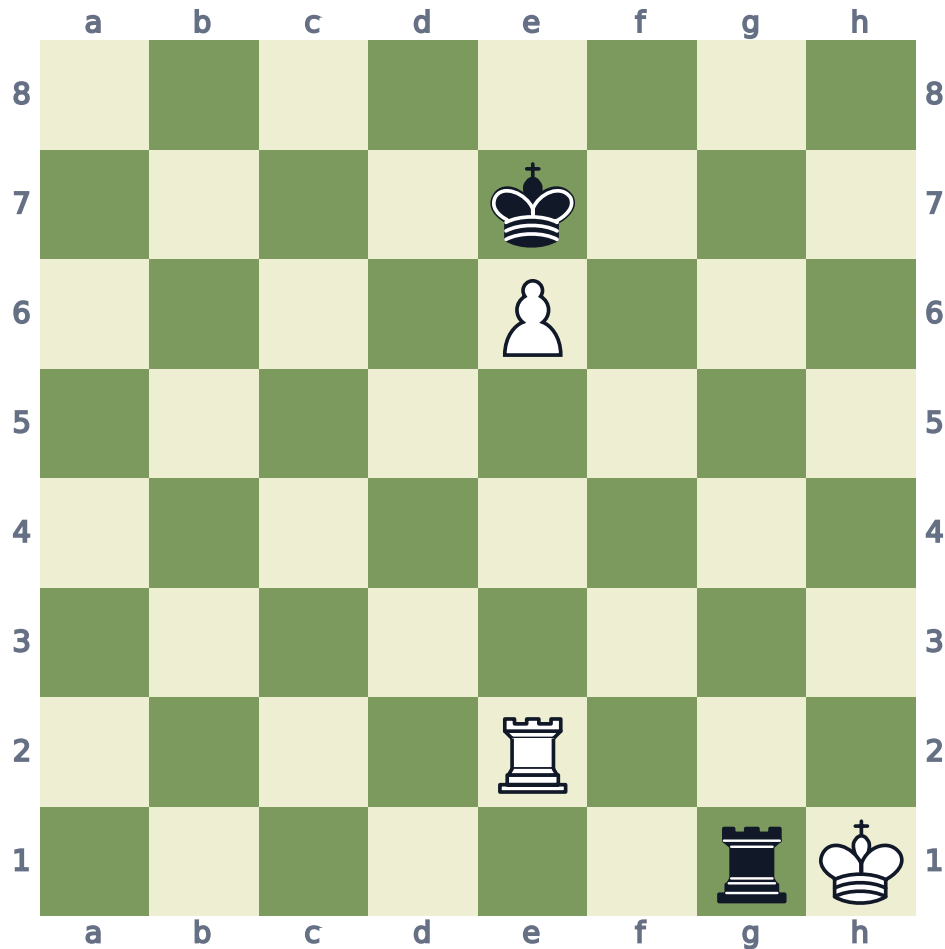
Practical

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 15 OF 32

Rook behind the passer



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

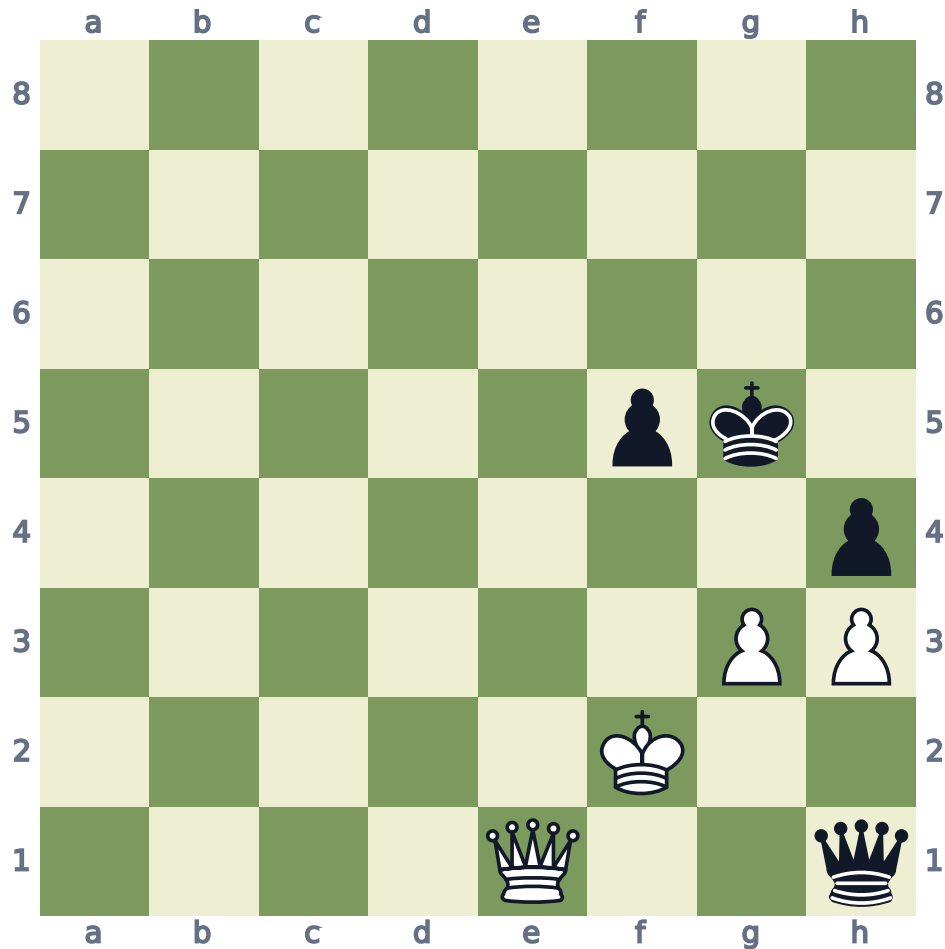
Practical

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 16 OF 32

Queen checks



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

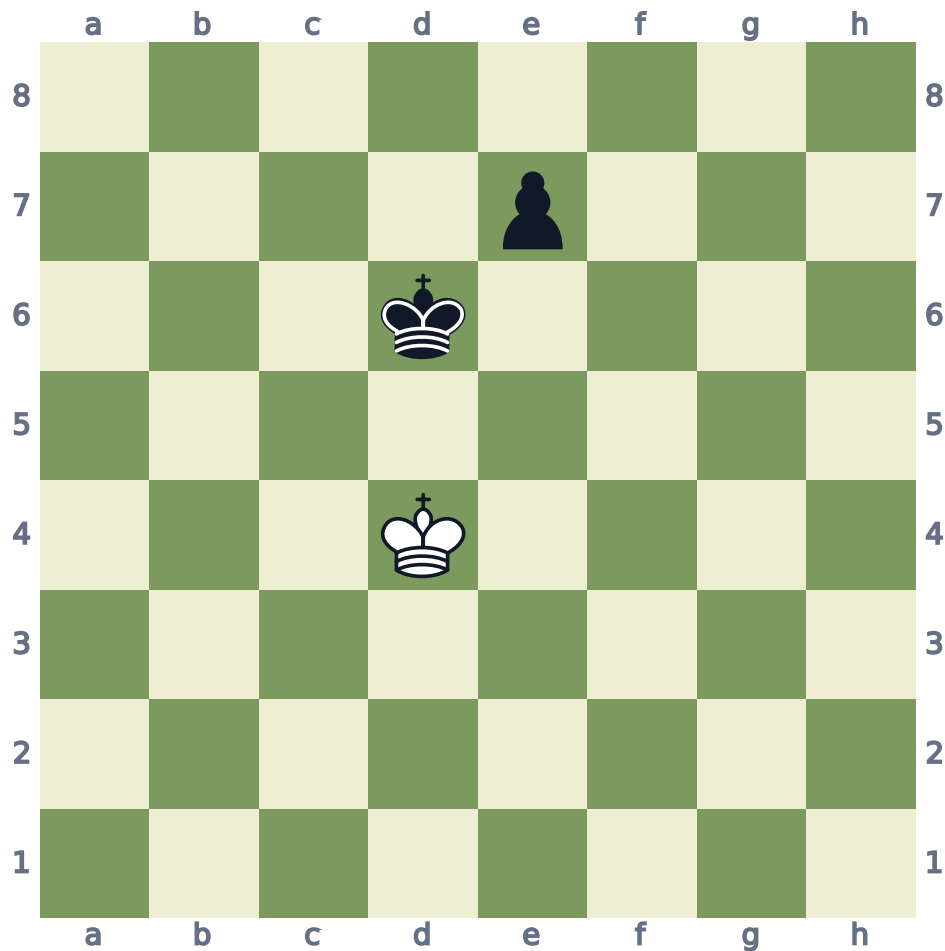
Practical

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 17 OF 32

King and pawn: key squares - reverse colors



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

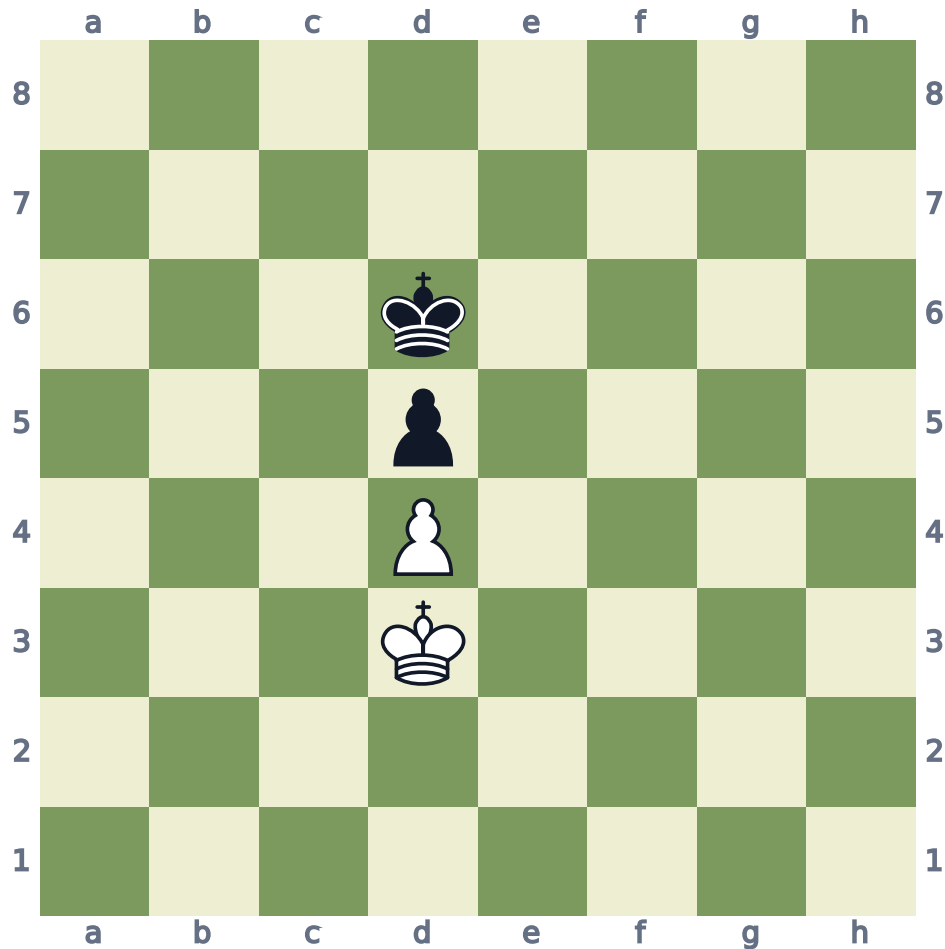
Technical

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 18 OF 32

Direct opposition - reverse colors



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

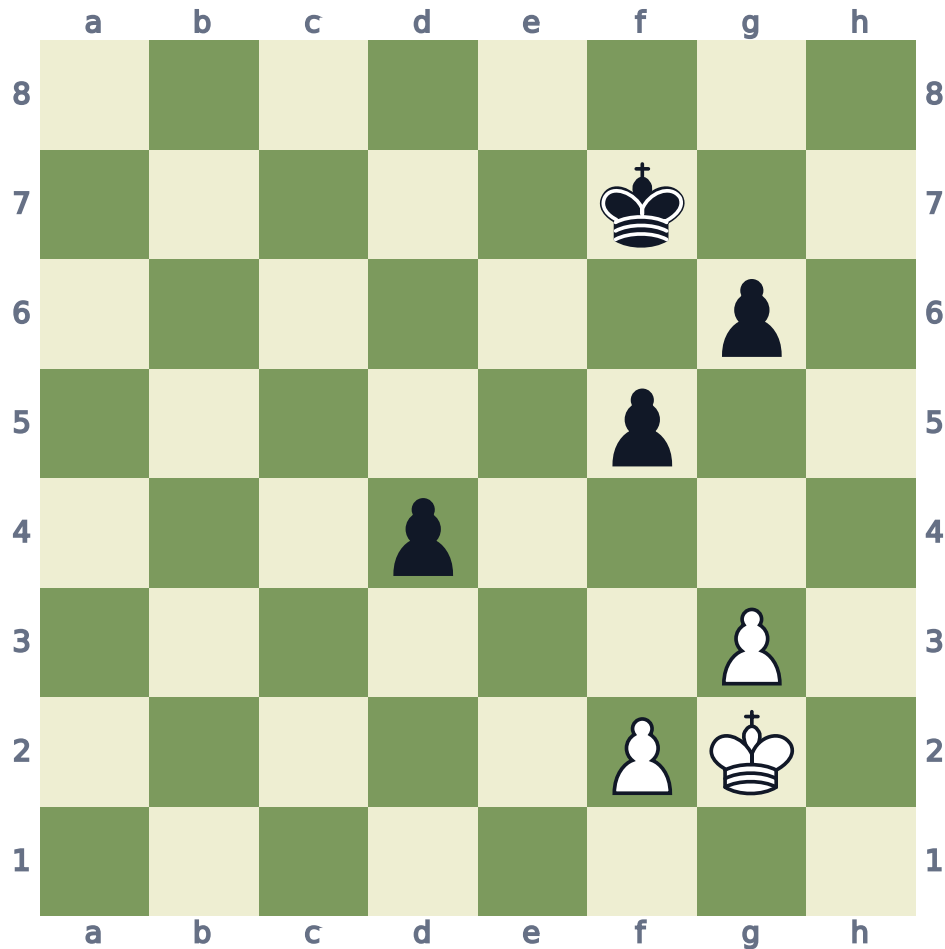
Technical

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 19 OF 32

Outside passed pawn - reverse colors



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

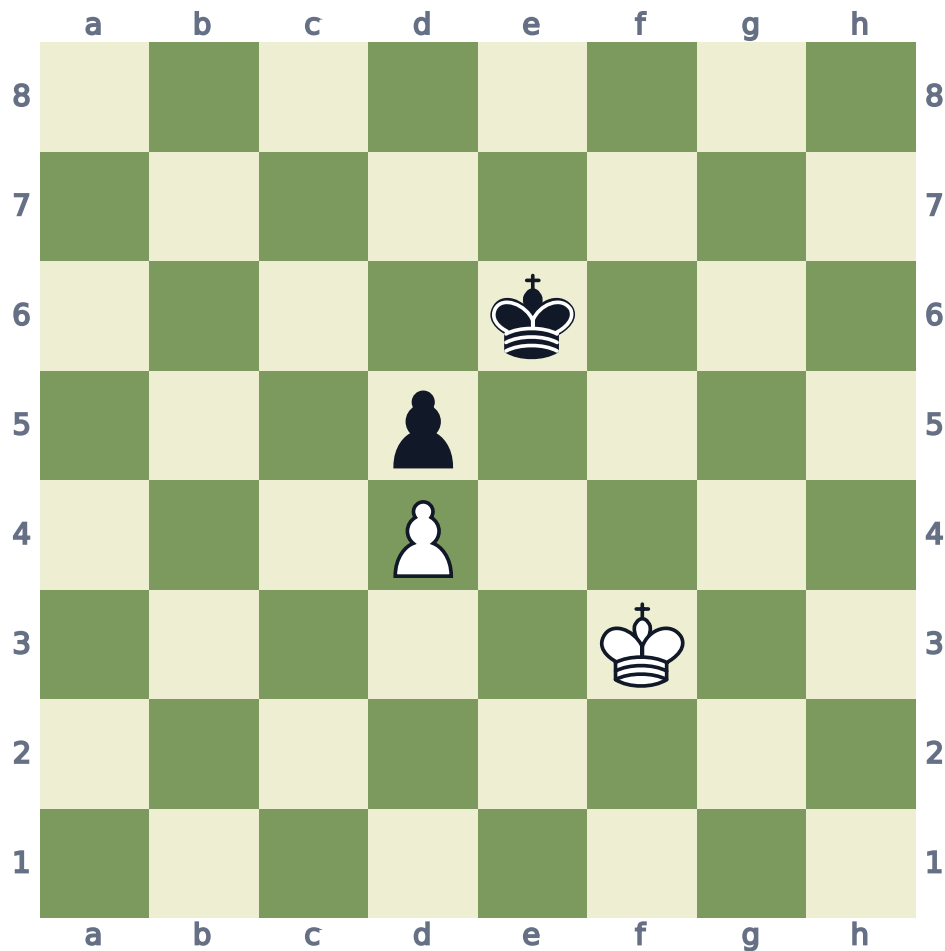
Technical

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 20 OF 32

Reserve tempo - reverse colors



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

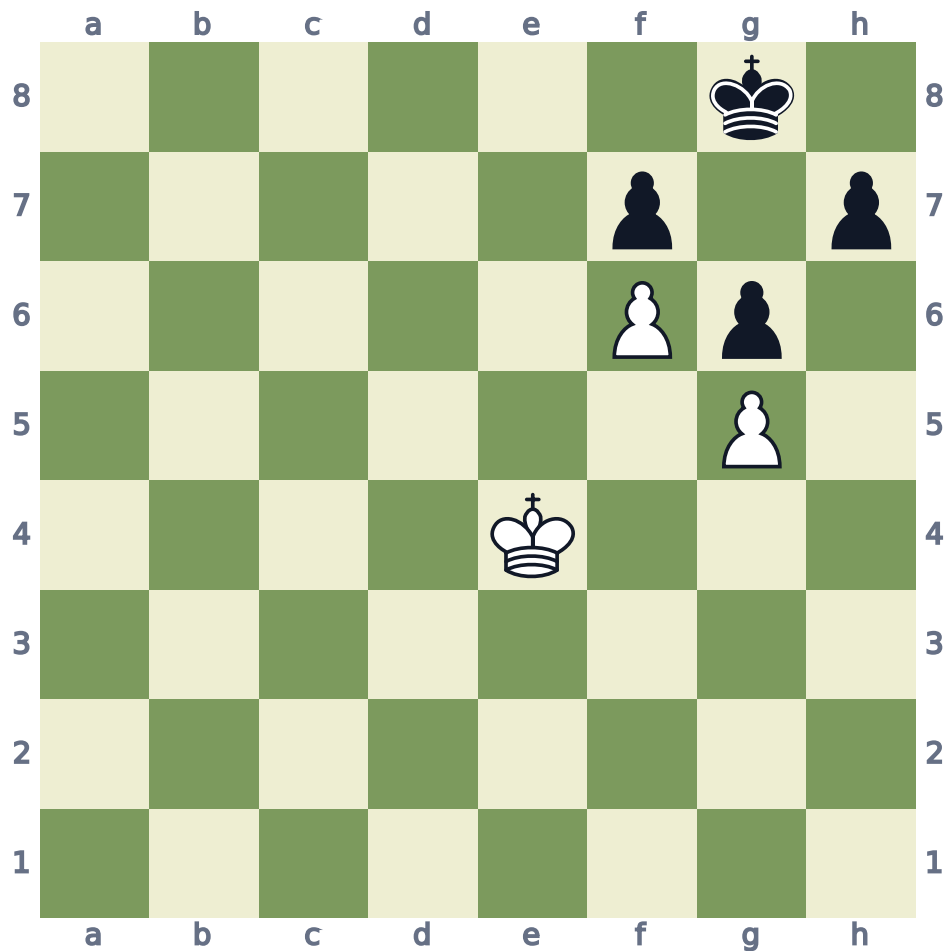
Technical

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 21 OF 32

Pawn breakthrough - reverse colors



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

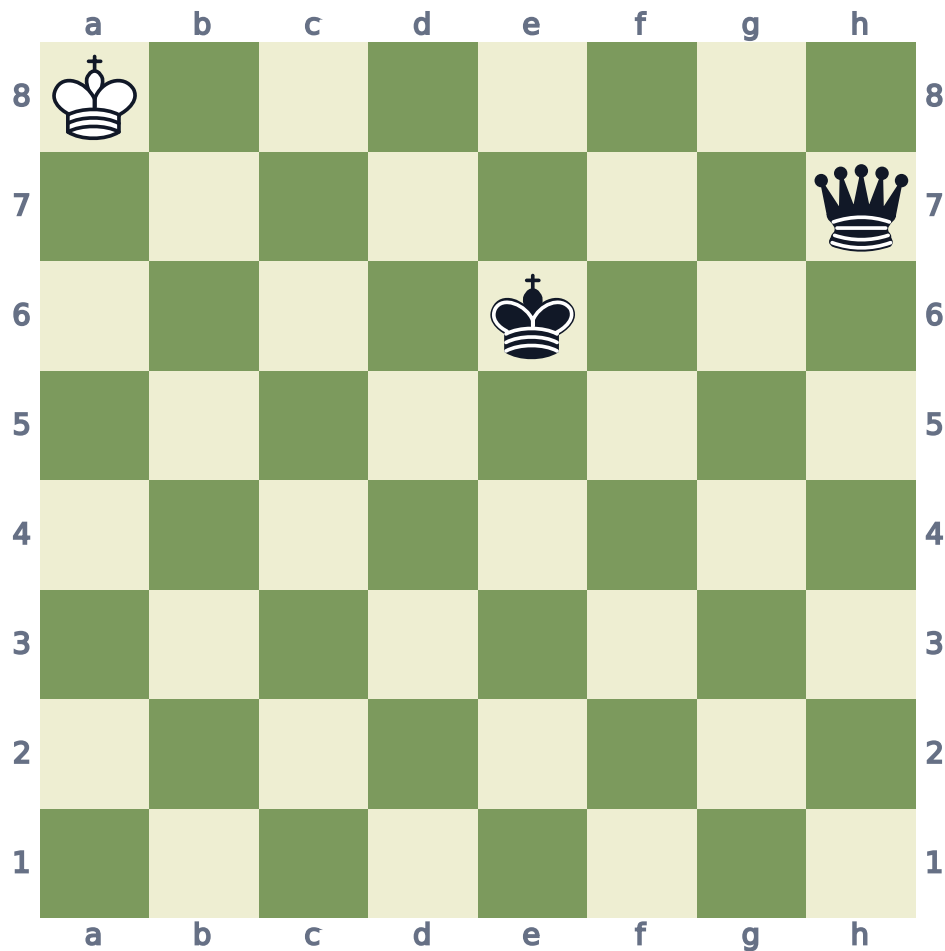
Technical

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 22 OF 32

Queen mate technique - reverse colors

**YOUR TASK**

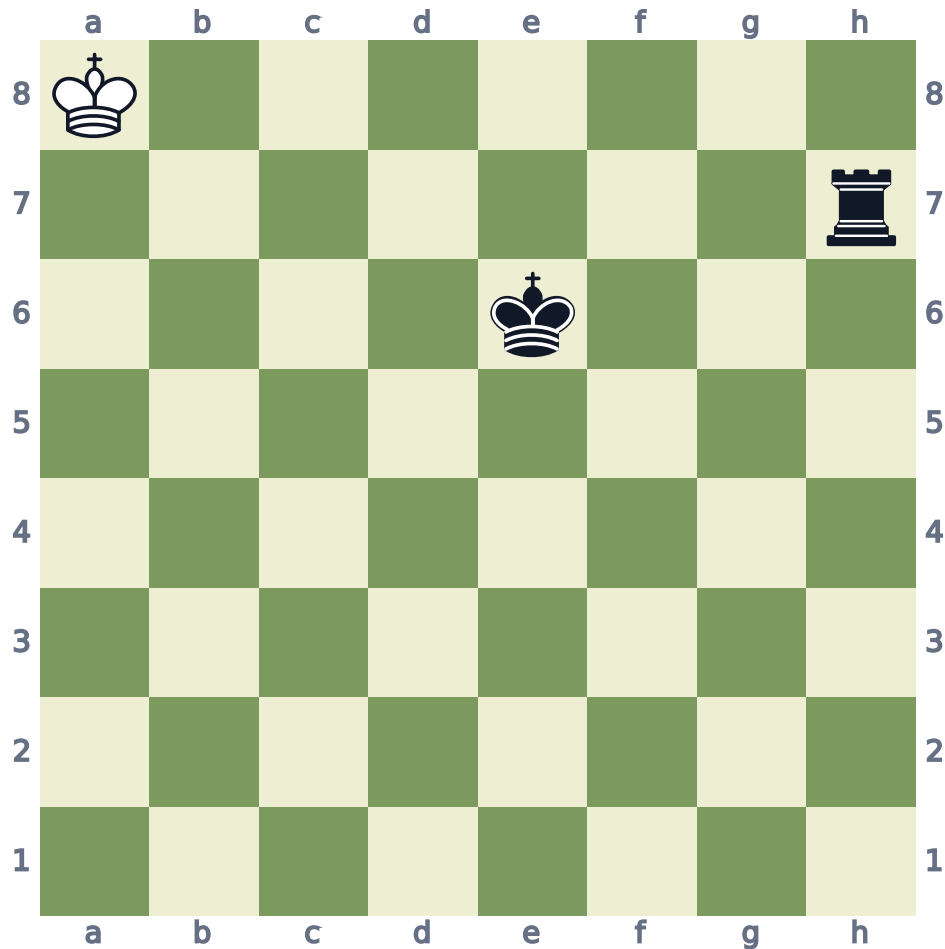
Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY**Technical****BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION**

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 23 OF 32

Rook mate technique - reverse colors



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

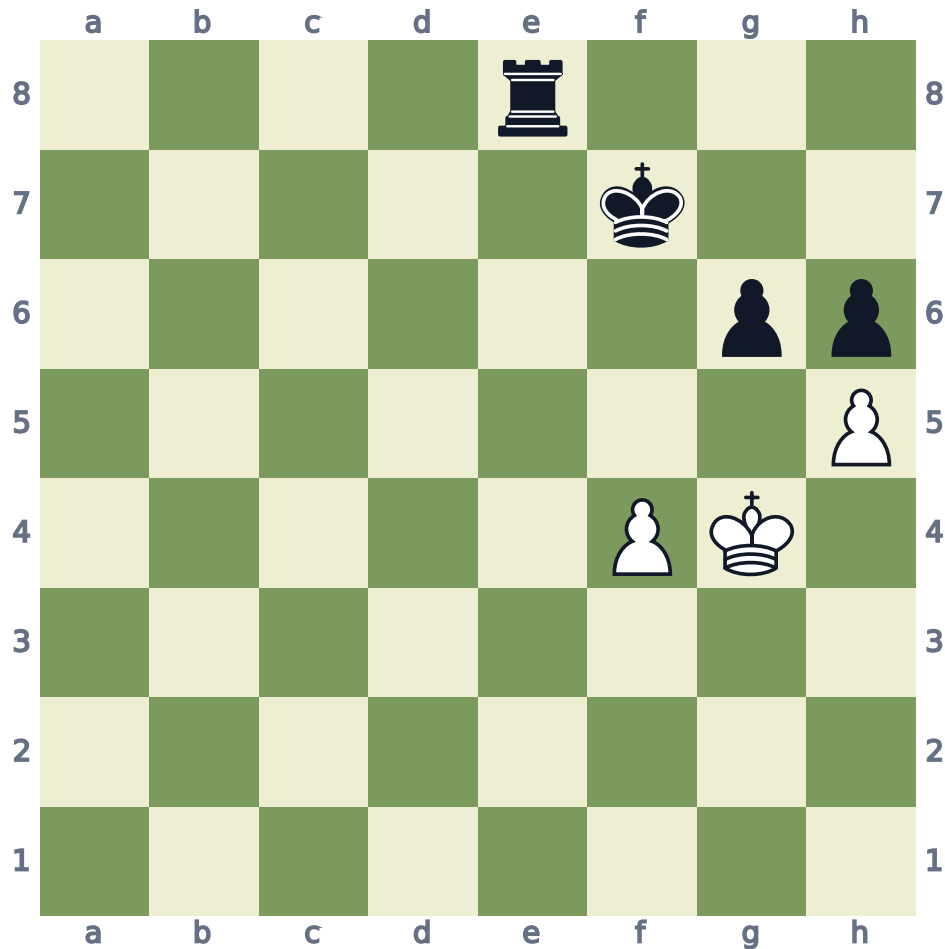
Technical

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 24 OF 32

Rook activity - reverse colors



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

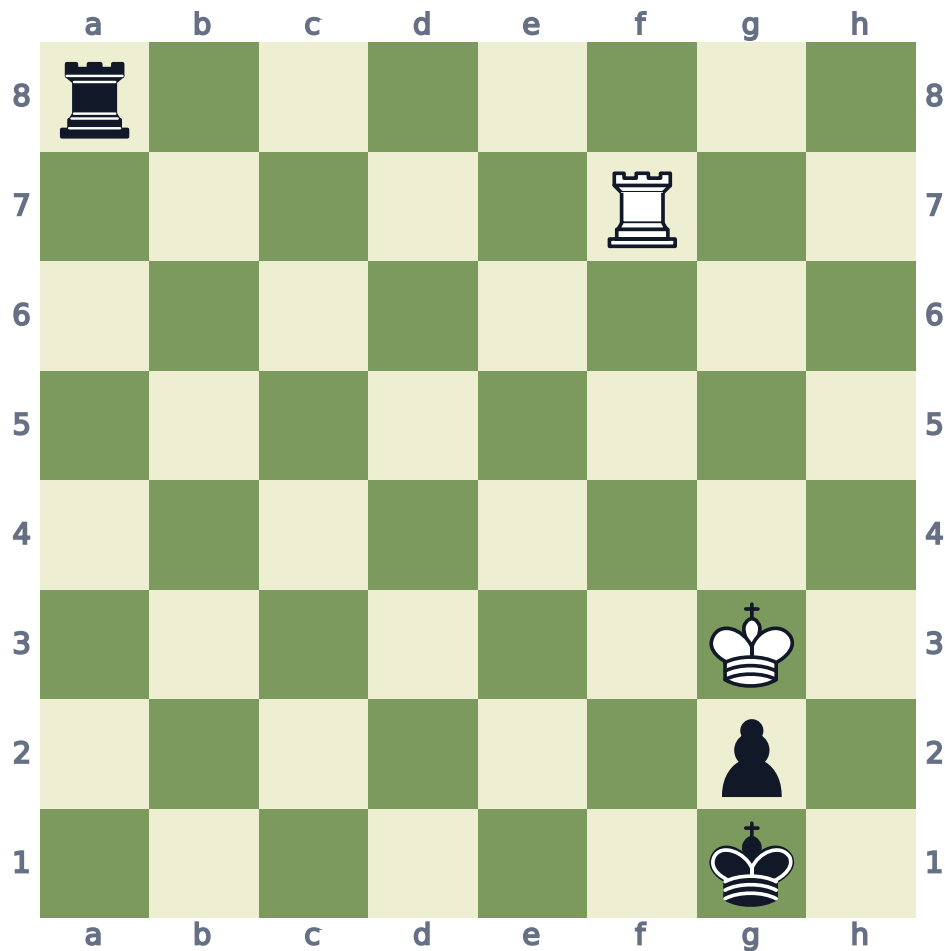
Technical

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 25 OF 32

Lucena bridge - reverse colors



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

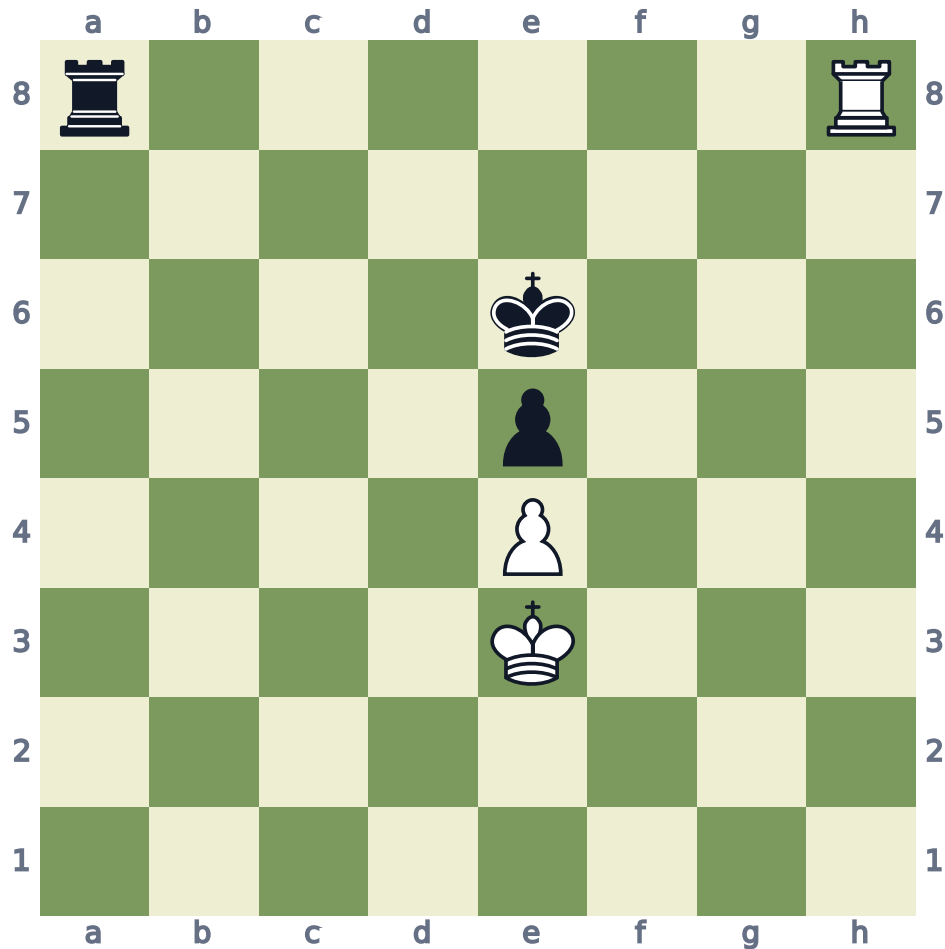
Reverse-side defense

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 26 OF 32

Rook checks from behind - reverse colors



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

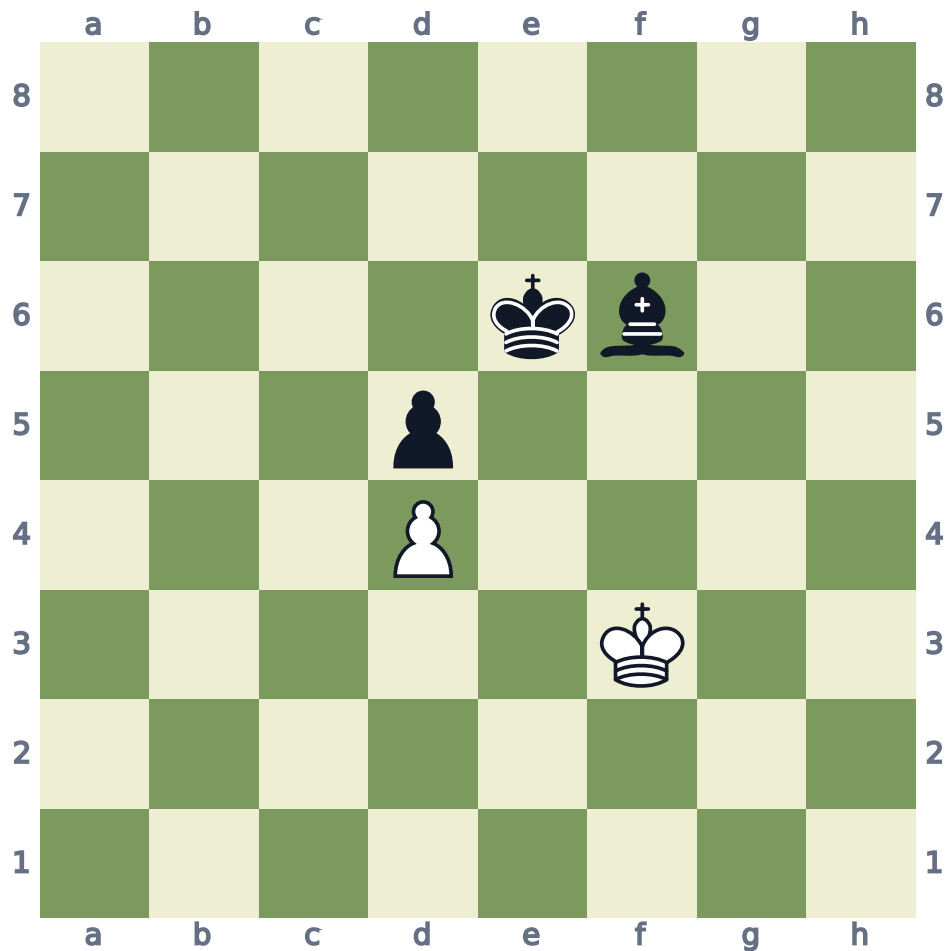
Reverse-side defense

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 27 OF 32

Bishop against pawns - reverse colors



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

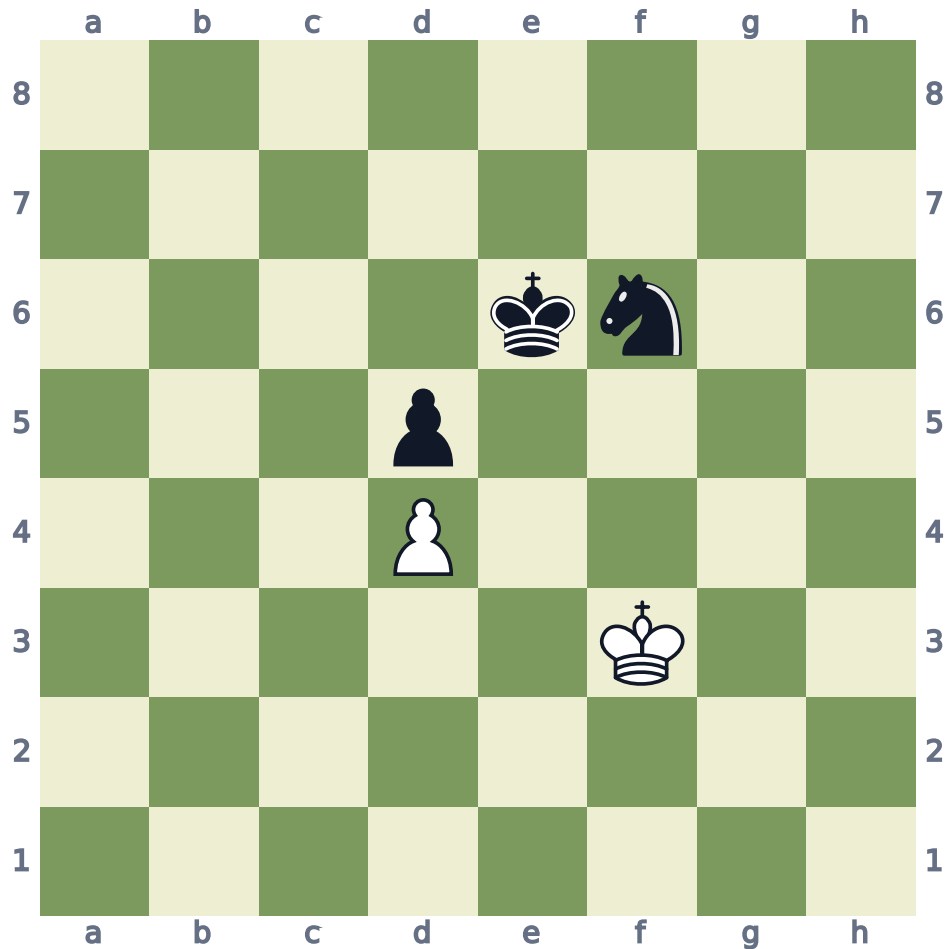
Reverse-side defense

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 28 OF 32

Knight against pawns - reverse colors



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

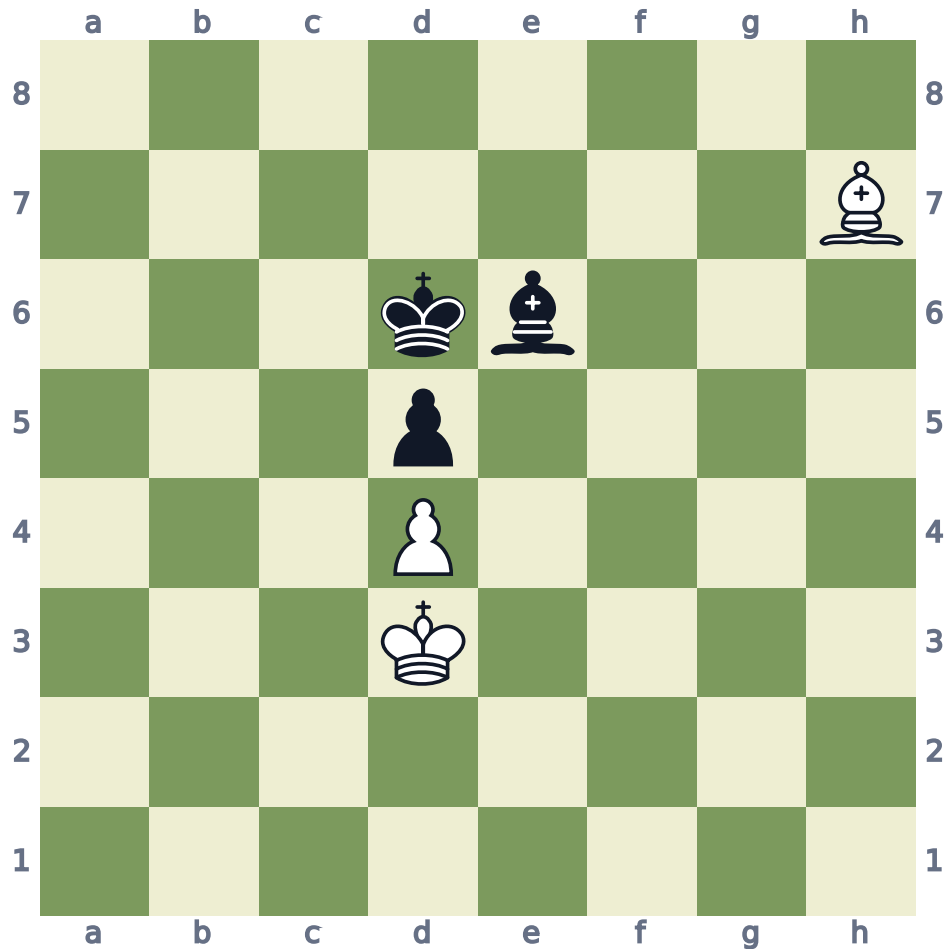
Reverse-side defense

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 29 OF 32

Opposite-colored bishops - reverse colors



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

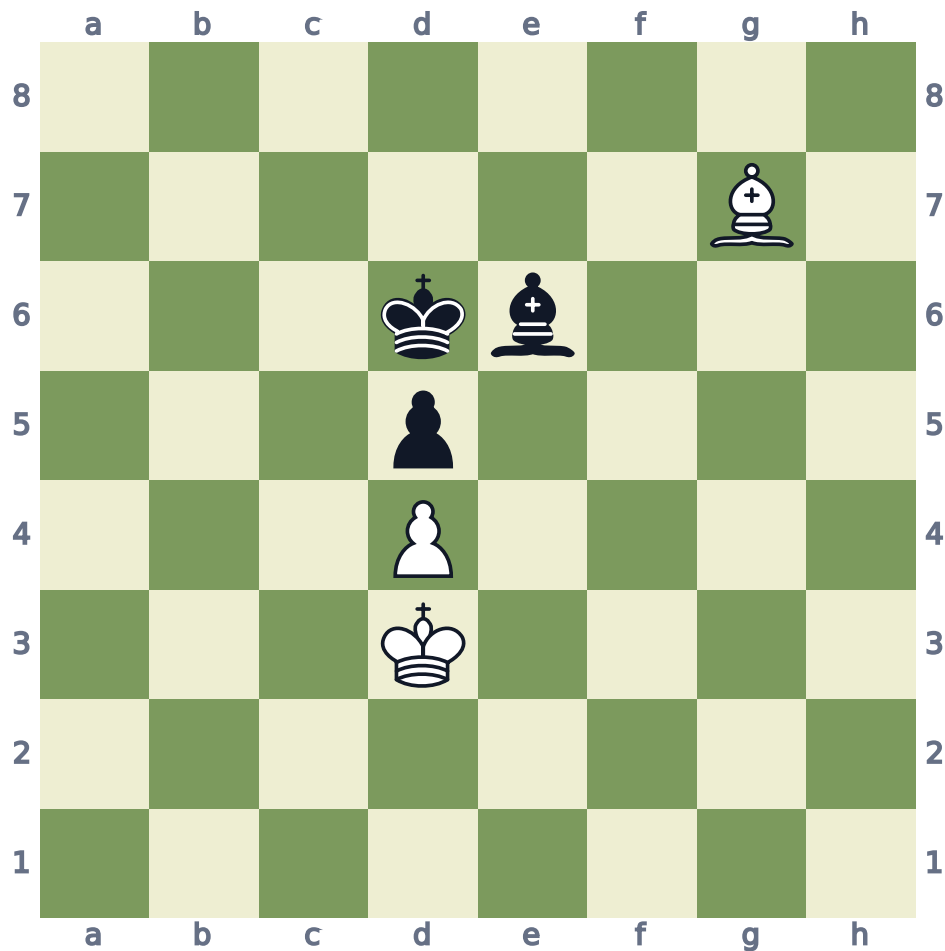
Reverse-side defense

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 30 OF 32

Same-colored bishops - reverse colors



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

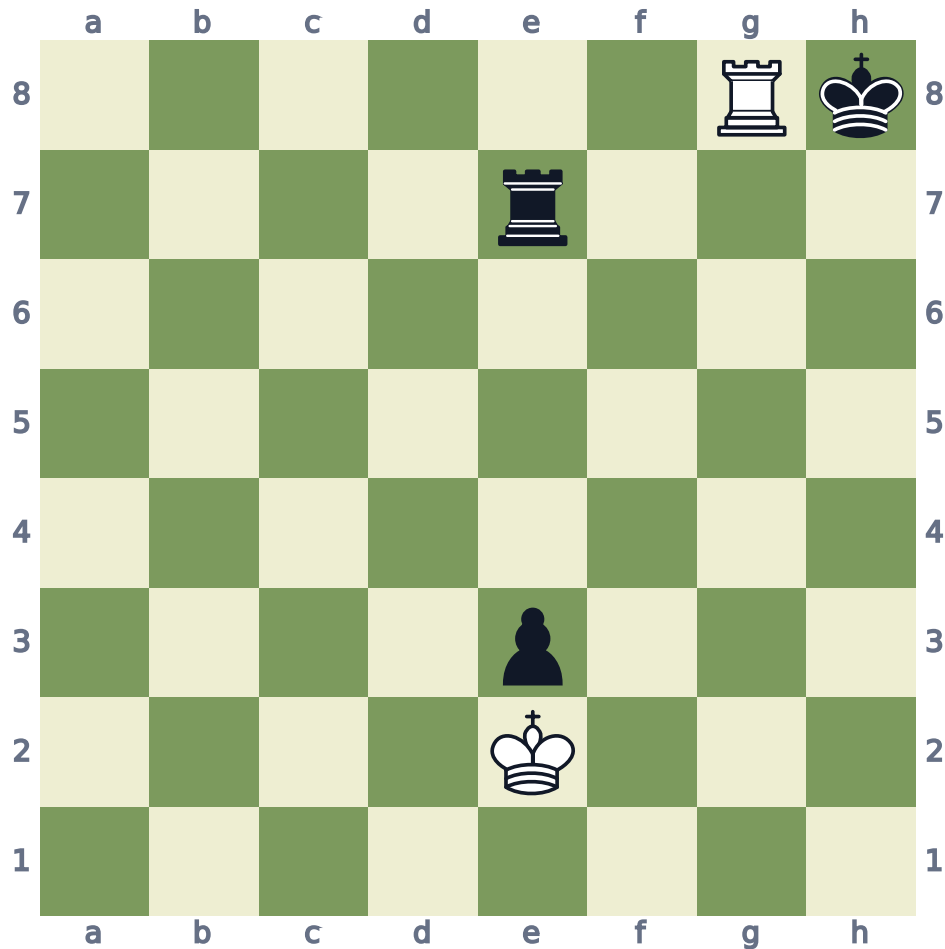
Reverse-side defense

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 31 OF 32

Rook behind the passer - reverse colors



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

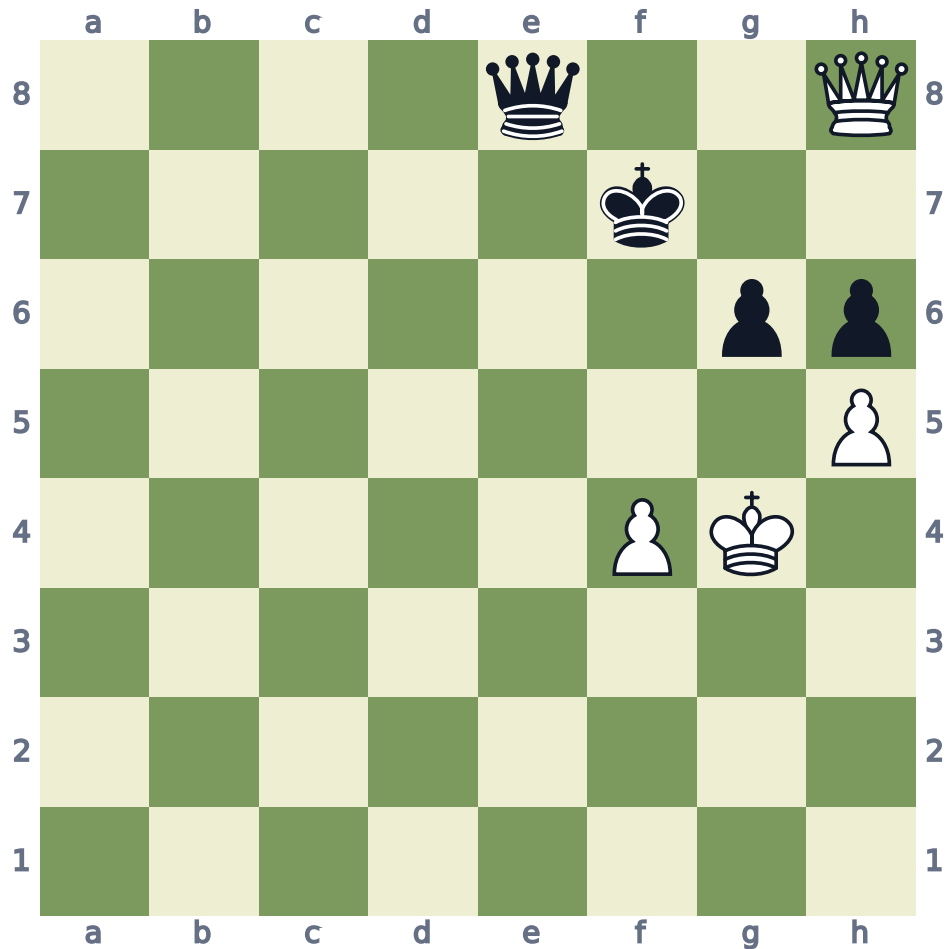
Reverse-side defense

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 32 OF 32

Queen checks - reverse colors



YOUR TASK

Find the exact method. Calculate checks, captures, pawn races, promotions, and stalemate before applying an endgame rule.

DIFFICULTY

Reverse-side defense

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

ANSWER SECTION

Solutions begin on the next page

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not browse the solution pages casually. Return to each problem, reconstruct the position, and compare the entire decision process. If your move matches but your line omits the best defense, score it as incomplete.

ERROR LABELS

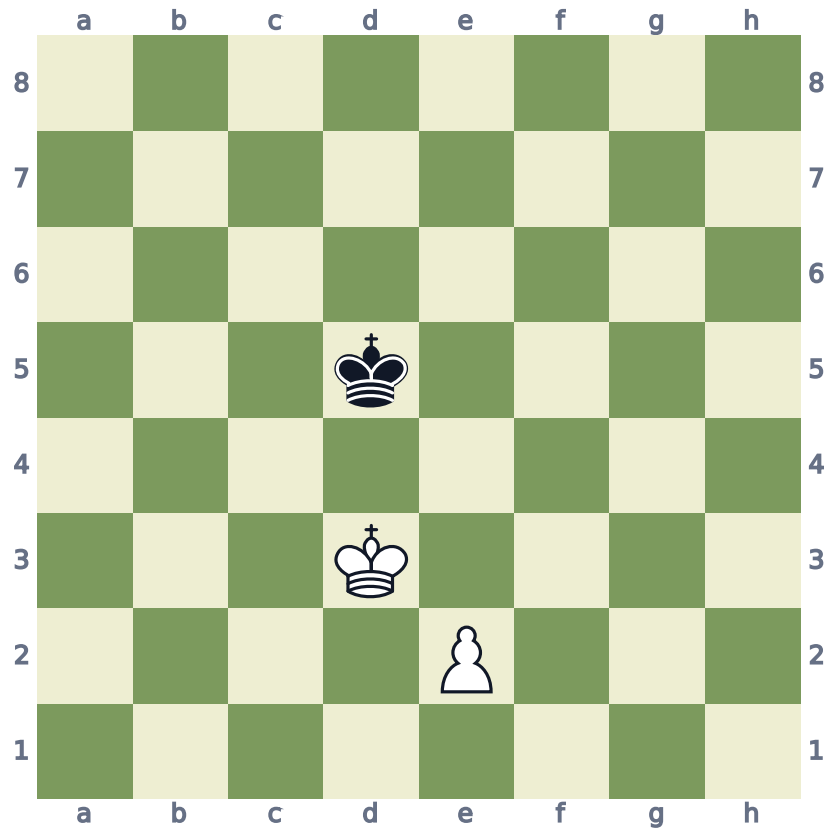
R = recognition error | C = candidate error | V = visualization error | D = missed defense | E = endpoint evaluation error | T = time-management error

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce one replacement question. Example: 'Before I calculate my attack, what countercheck does the opponent have?' Use that question in the next five slow games.

SOLUTION 01 OF 32

King and pawn: key squares



VERIFIED LINE

1. e3 Ke5 2. Kc3 Ke4 3. Kd2 Kf5 4. Kd3

WHY IT WORKS

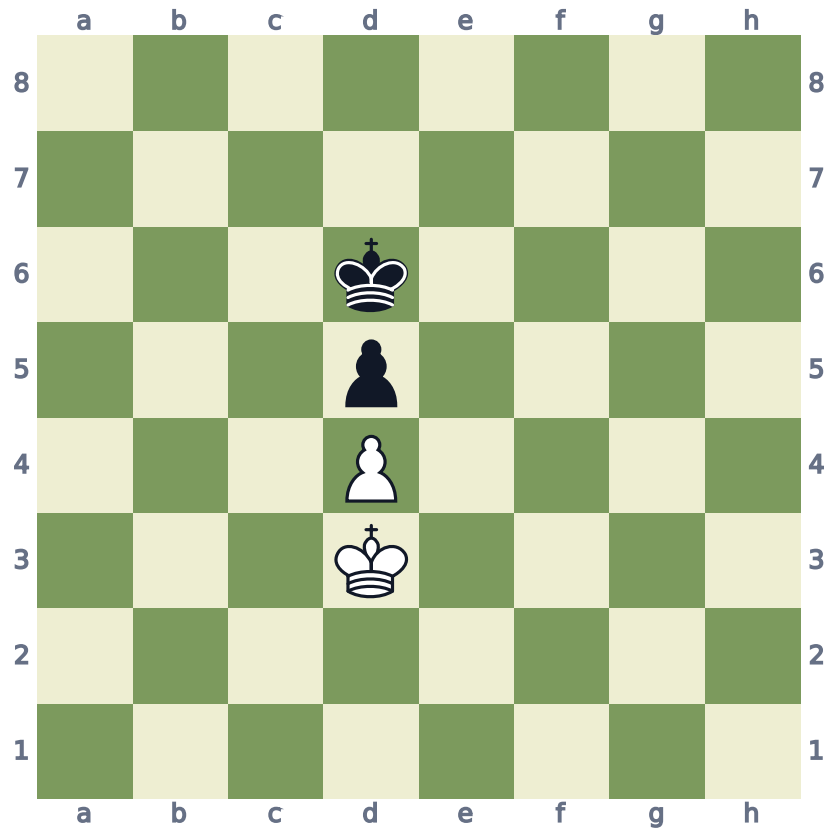
Reach the key squares without spending the pawn too early. The second engine candidate scores +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.00.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 02 OF 32

Direct opposition



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kc2 Kc6 2. Kc3 Kb5 3. Kb3 Ka5 4. Ka3 Kb5 5. Kb3

WHY IT WORKS

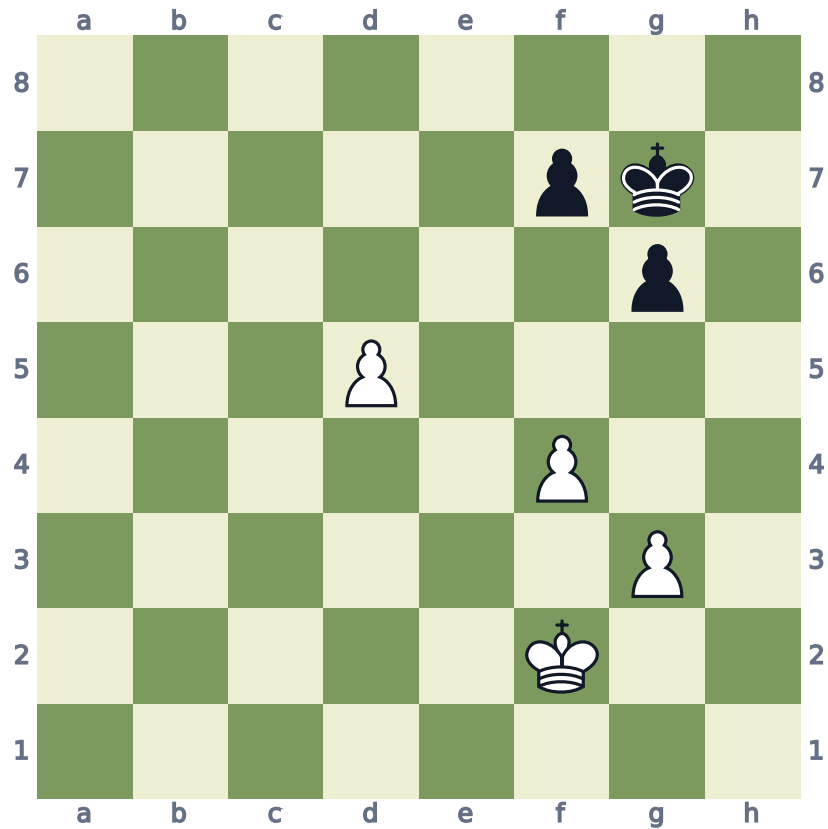
Use opposition to gain or deny entry. The second engine candidate scores +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.00.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 03 OF 32

Outside passed pawn



VERIFIED LINE

1. Ke3 Kf6 2. Ke4 Ke7 3. g4 f6 4. g5 Kf7 5. Kd4 Ke7

WHY IT WORKS

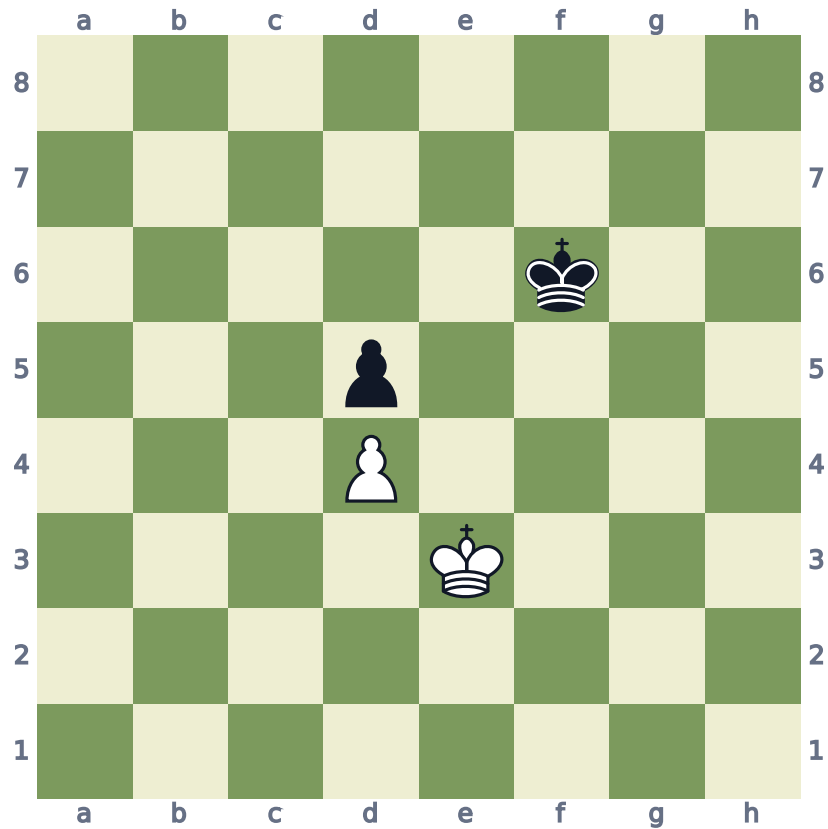
Calculate whether the outside passer distracts the king in time. The second engine candidate scores +5.24 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.13.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +5.37 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 04 OF 32

Reserve tempo



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kg5 Kf3 2. Kf5 Ke3 3. Kg4 Ke2 4. Kf4 Kd3 5. Kf3 Kd2

WHY IT WORKS

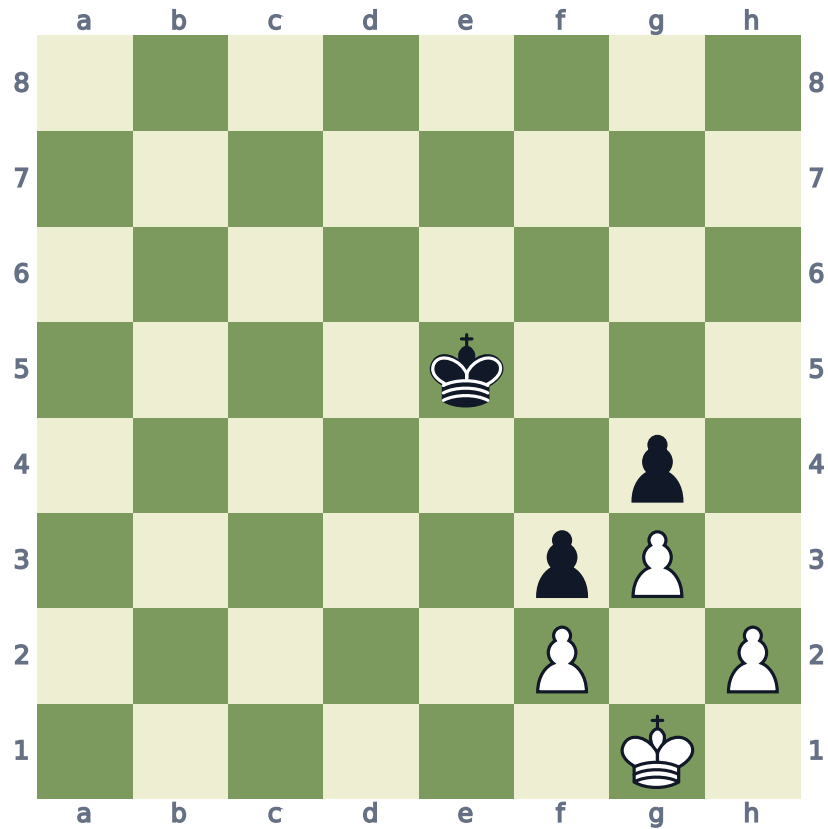
A pawn move can be the final reserve tempo in a zugzwang. The second engine candidate scores +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.54.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +0.54 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 05 OF 32

Pawn breakthrough



VERIFIED LINE

1. Ke4 h4 2. gxh3 Kh2 3. Kd3 g4 4. Ke2 g5 5. Kxf2 g6

WHY IT WORKS

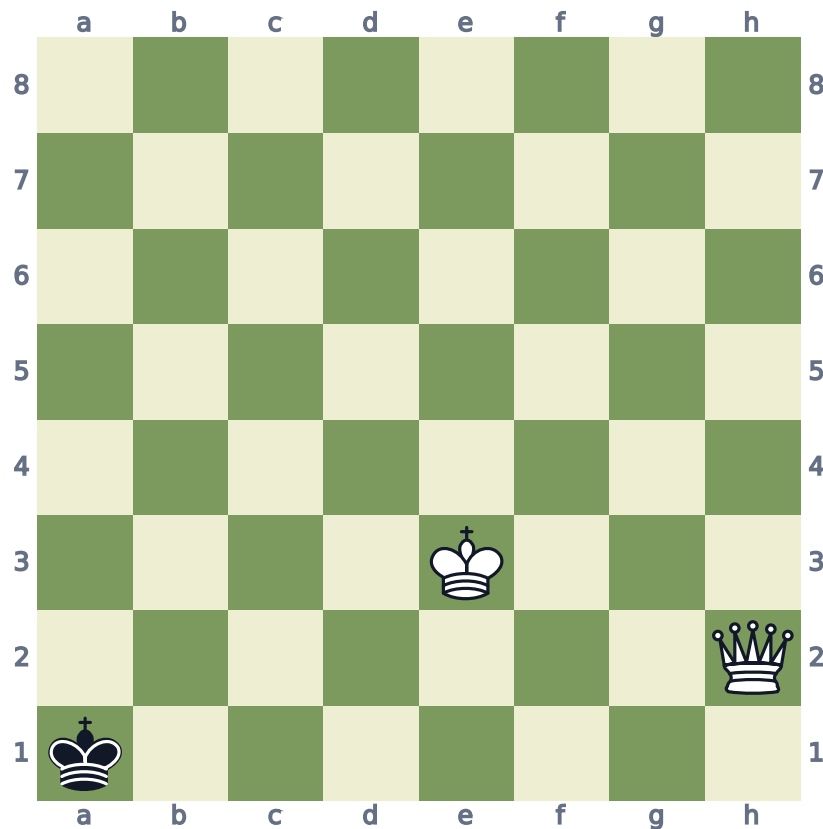
Look for a sacrifice that creates an unstoppable passer. The second engine candidate scores +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.00.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 06 OF 32

Queen mate technique



VERIFIED LINE

1. Qg2 Kb1 2. Kd3 Ka1 3. Kc2 Ka2 4. Qa8#

WHY IT WORKS

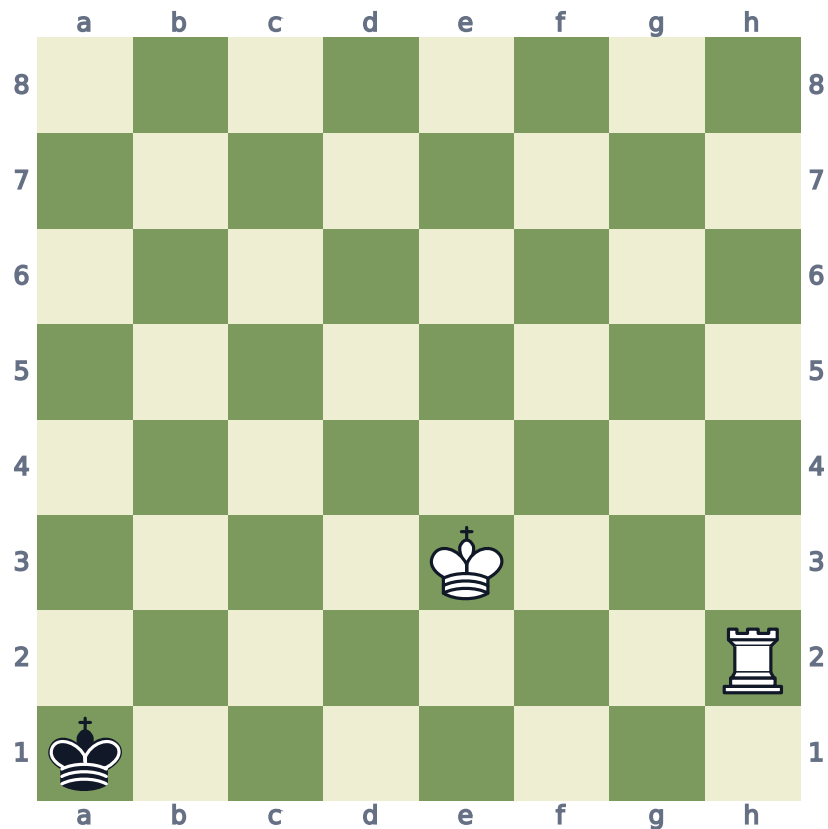
Restrict the king, bring your king, and avoid stalemate. The second engine candidate scores mate in 4; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.00.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: mate in 4.

SOLUTION 07 OF 32

Rook mate technique



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kd4 Kb1 2. Kc3 Ka1 3. Rg2 Kb1 4. Rg6 Ka2 5. Ra6+ Kb1

WHY IT WORKS

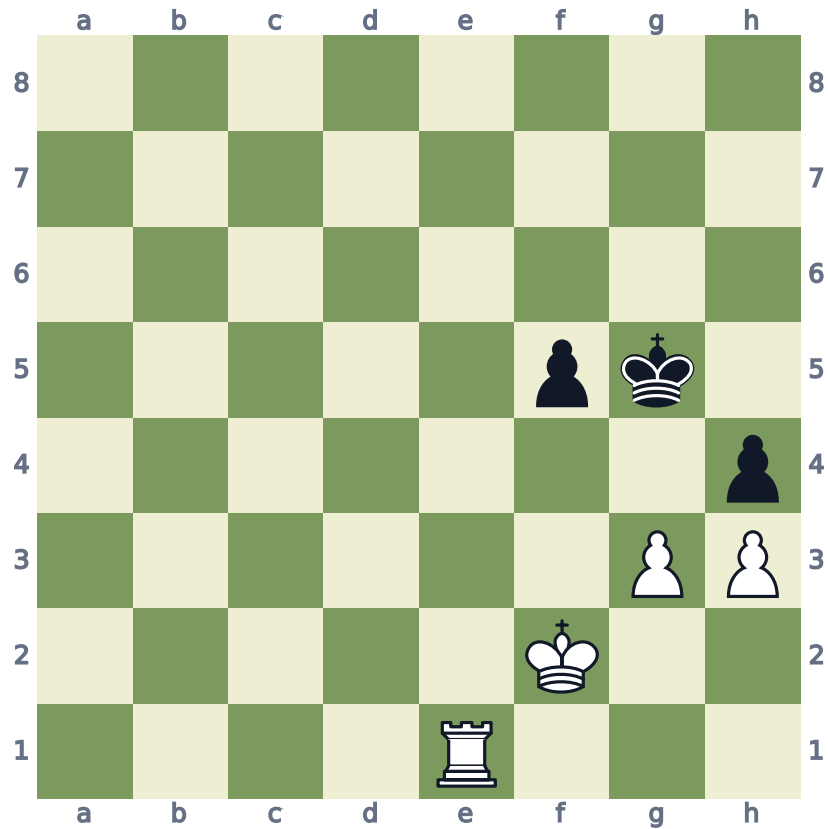
Cut off the king and shrink the box. The second engine candidate scores mate in 7; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.00.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: mate in 7.

SOLUTION 08 OF 32

Rook activity



VERIFIED LINE

1. gxh4+ Kf4 2. h5 Kg5 3. Kf3 f4 4. Re5+ Kh6 5. Kxf4 Kh7

WHY IT WORKS

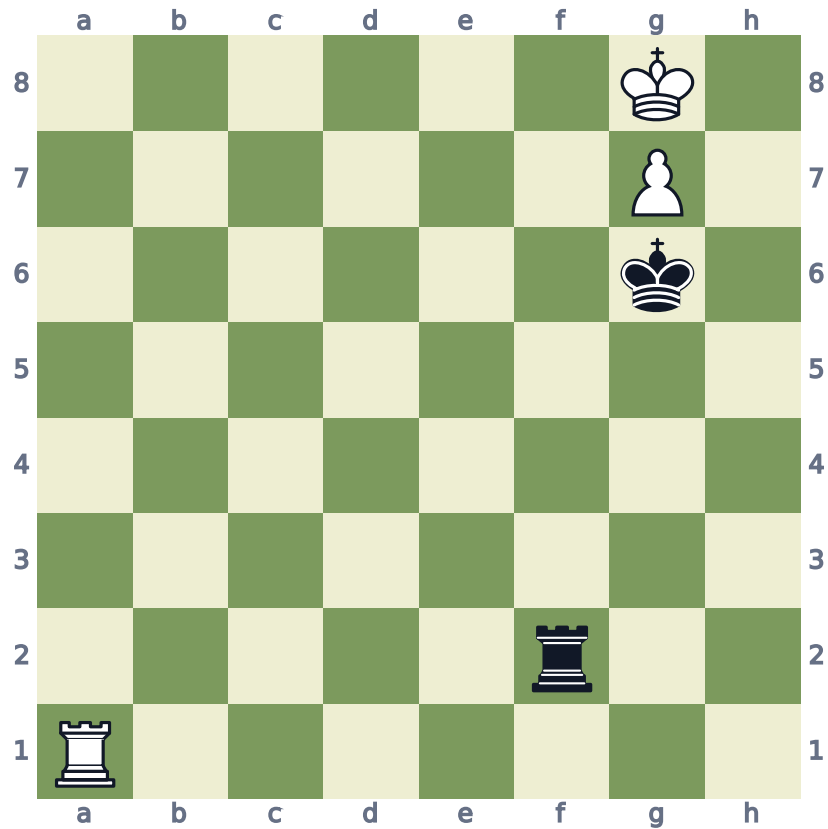
Activate the rook before collecting pawns. The second engine candidate scores +6.57 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.46.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +7.03 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 09 OF 32

Lucena bridge



VERIFIED LINE

1. Rh1 Rb2 2. Kh8 Rb8+ 3. g8=R+ Rxg8+ 4. Kxg8 Kf5 5. Rh6 Kg5

WHY IT WORKS

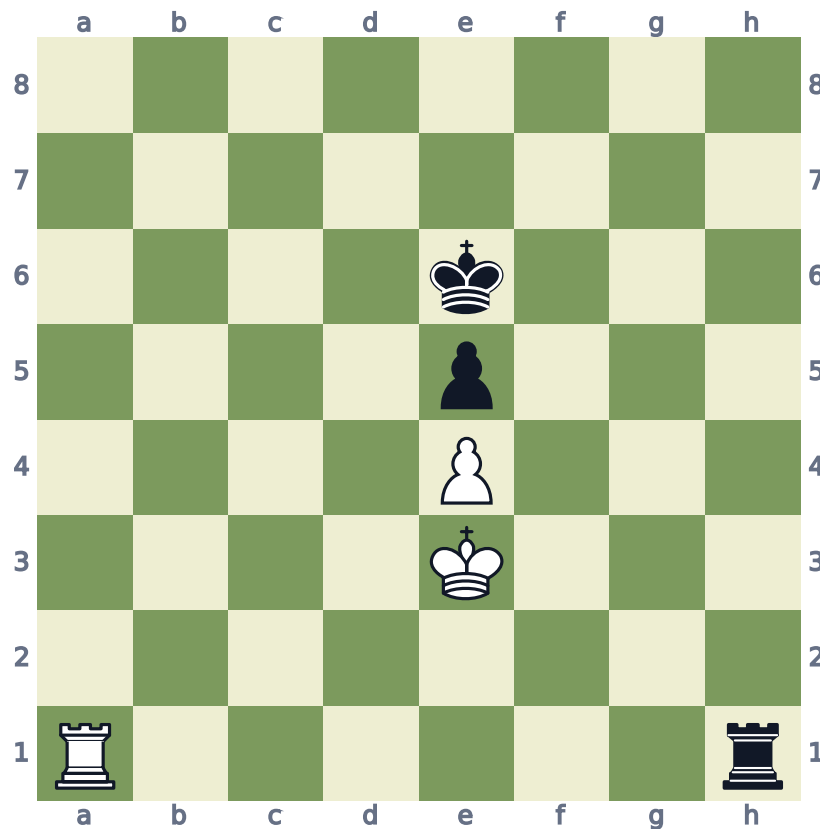
Build a bridge so the king can escape checks and promote. The second engine candidate scores +4.34 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.22.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +4.56 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 10 OF 32

Rook checks from behind



VERIFIED LINE

1. Rxh1 Kd6 2. Kf3 Kc5 3. Kg4 Kd4 4. Kf5 Ke3 5. Kxe5 Kf3

WHY IT WORKS

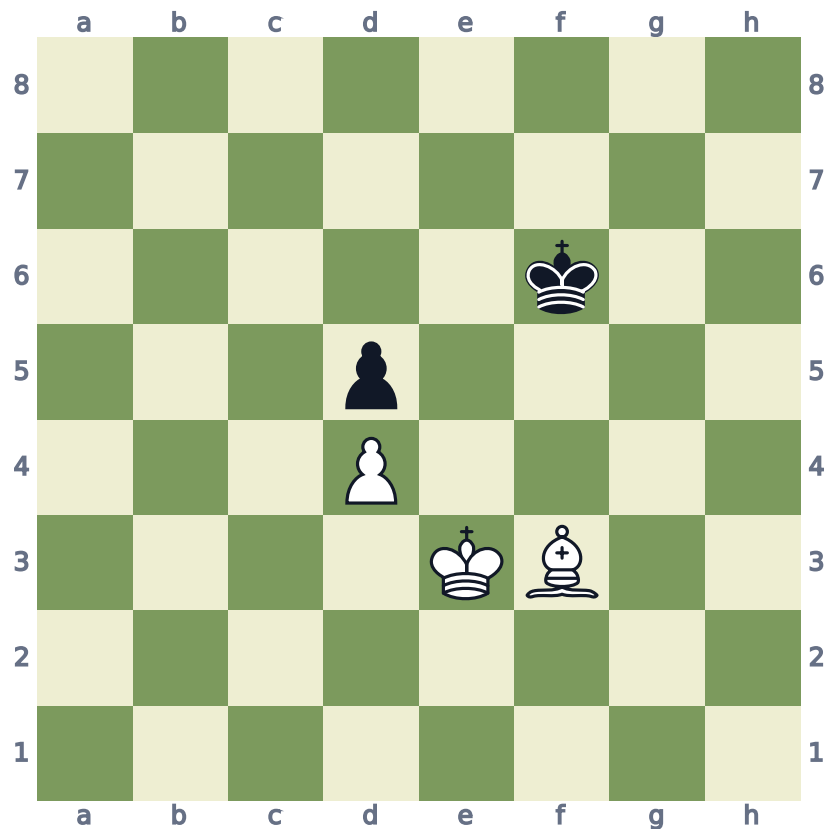
Compare checking distance with passive defense. The second engine candidate scores +0.11 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 5.97.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +6.08 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 11 OF 32

Bishop against pawns

**VERIFIED LINE**

1. Kf4 Ke7 2. Ke5 Kd8 3. Bxd5 Ke8 4. Bb3 Kd8 5. Ba4 Ke7

WHY IT WORKS

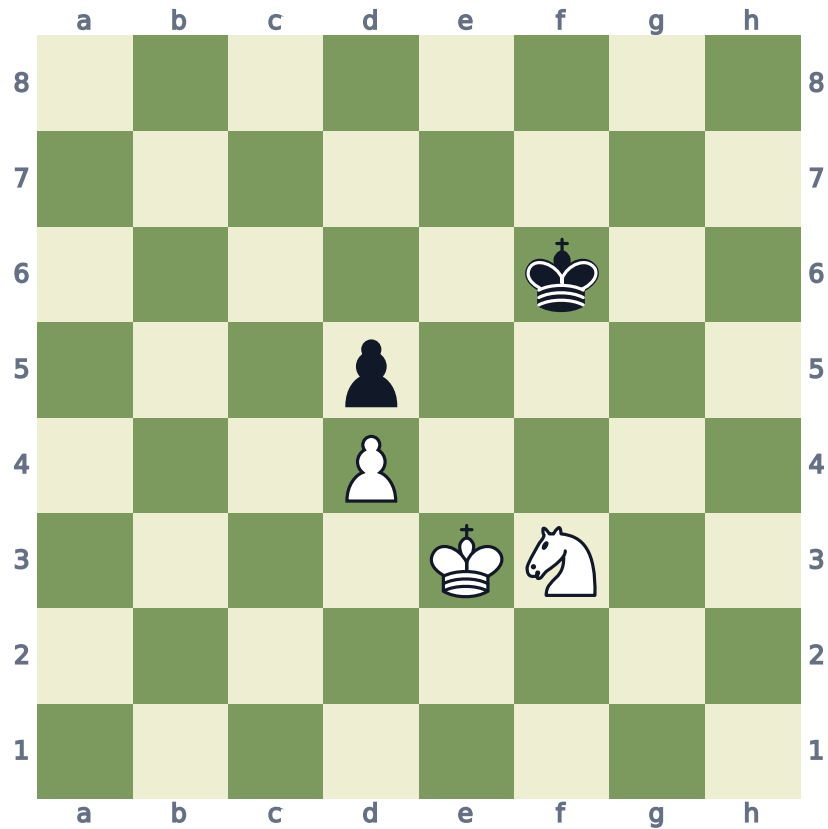
Use the bishop's waiting moves and the king's route. The second engine candidate scores +6.43 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.11.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +6.54 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 12 OF 32

Knight against pawns



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kf4 Kg6 2. Ke5 Kh6 3. Kf6 Kh5 4. Kf5 Kh6 5. Nh4 Kh5

WHY IT WORKS

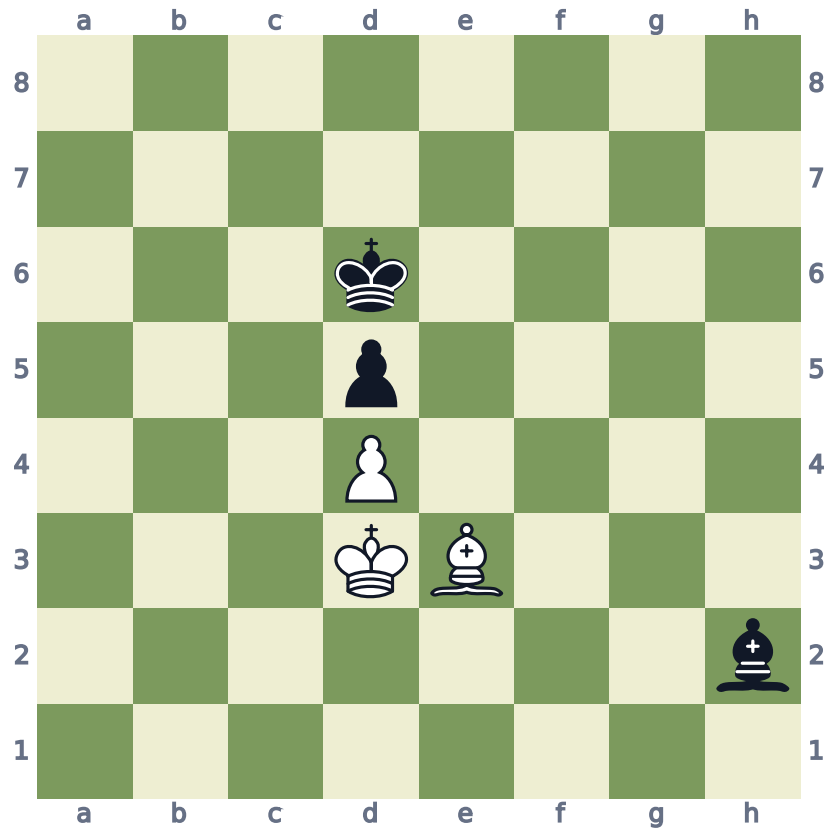
Calculate whether the knight can blockade without losing tempi. The second engine candidate scores +5.10 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.18.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +5.28 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 13 OF 32

Opposite-colored bishops



VERIFIED LINE

1. Bf2 Ke6 2. Kc3 Kf5 3. Kb4 Kg4 4. Kc5 Kg5 5. Be1

WHY IT WORKS

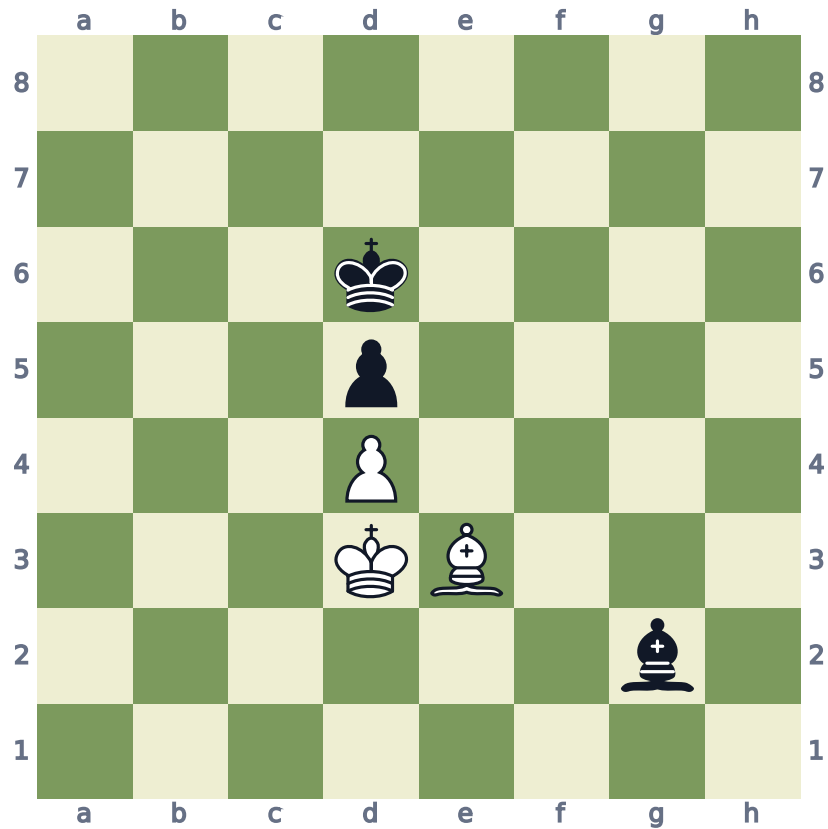
Activity and king entry often matter more than a nominal extra pawn. The second engine candidate scores -0.05 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.01.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -0.04 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 14 OF 32

Same-colored bishops



VERIFIED LINE

1. Ke2 Ke6 2. Kf2 Be4 3. Kg3 Bg6 4. Kf4 Kf6 5. Bf2 Be8

WHY IT WORKS

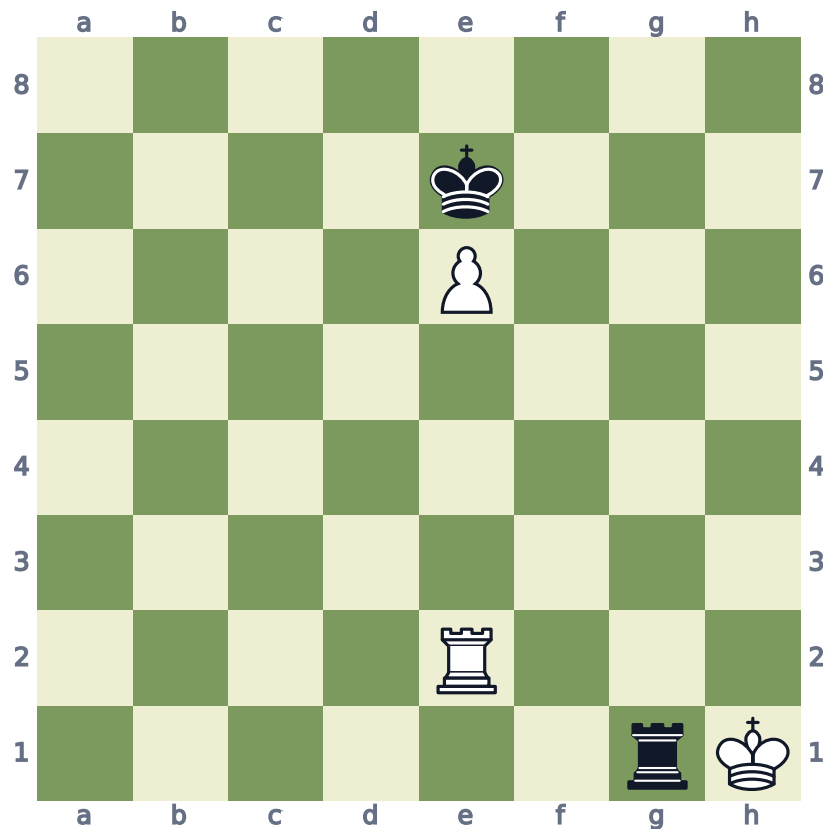
Fight for penetration squares on the shared color complex. The second engine candidate scores -0.02 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.02.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 15 OF 32

Rook behind the passer

**VERIFIED LINE**

1. Kxg1 Kd6 2. e7 Kd5 3. Re1 Kc4 4. e8=Q Kc3 5. Rd1 Kc2

WHY IT WORKS

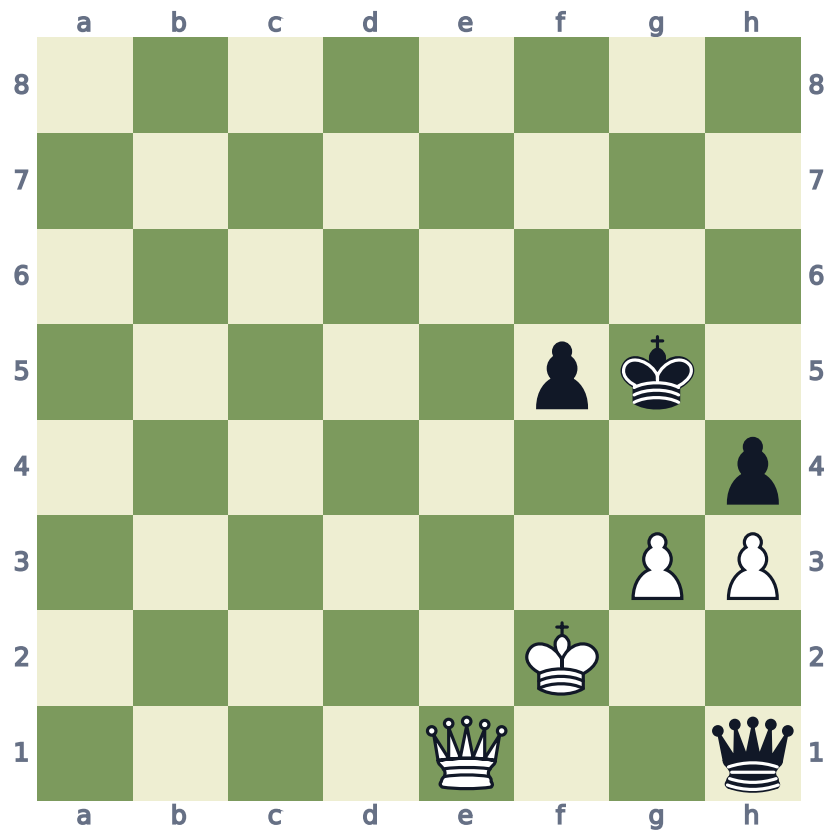
Place the rook behind the pawn and calculate checking resources. The second engine candidate scores +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 9.46.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +9.46 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 16 OF 32

Queen checks

**VERIFIED LINE**

1. gxh4+ Kf6 2. Qxh1 Ke5 3. Qc6 Kd4 4. Kf3 Kd3 5. h5 Kd2

WHY IT WORKS

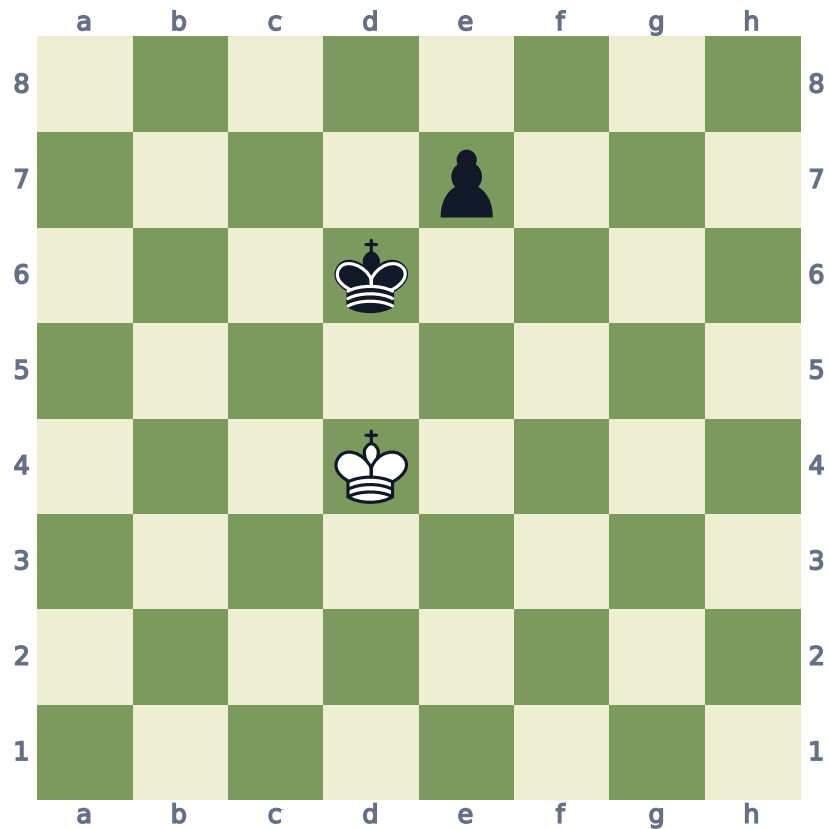
Checks, king exposure, and perpetual possibilities come before pawn counting. The second engine candidate scores +9.34 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 2.23.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +11.57 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 17 OF 32

King and pawn: key squares - reverse colors

**VERIFIED LINE**

1. e6 Ke4 2. Kc6 Ke5 3. Kd7 Kf4 4. Kd6

WHY IT WORKS

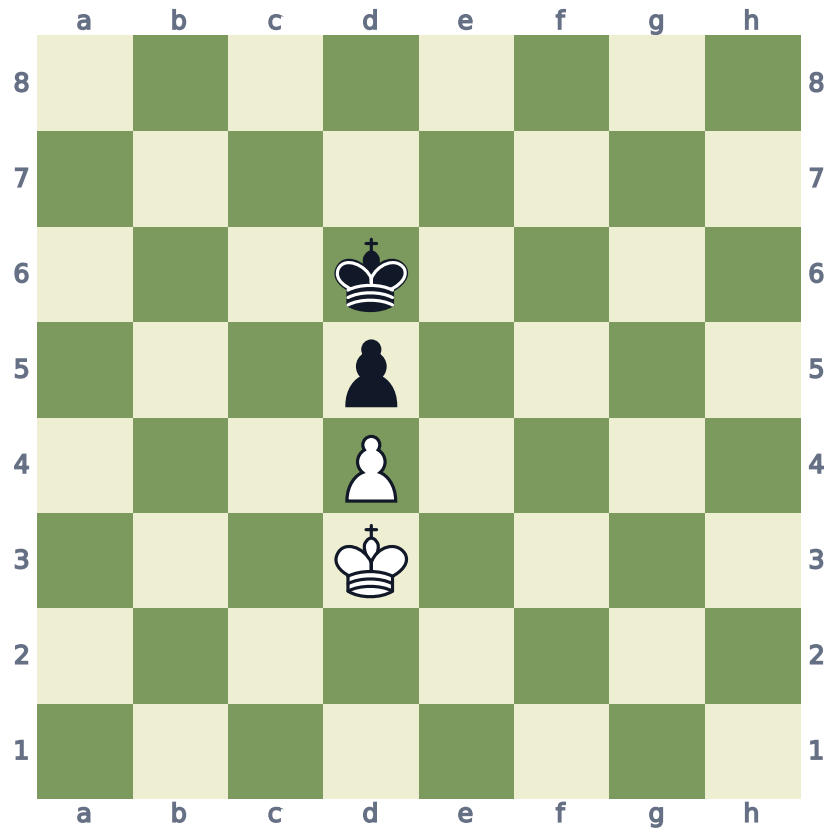
Reach the key squares without spending the pawn too early. The second engine candidate scores +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.00.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 18 OF 32

Direct opposition - reverse colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kd7 Ke2 2. Ke6 Ke3 3. Kf5 Kf3 4. Kg5 Kg3 5. Kf5

WHY IT WORKS

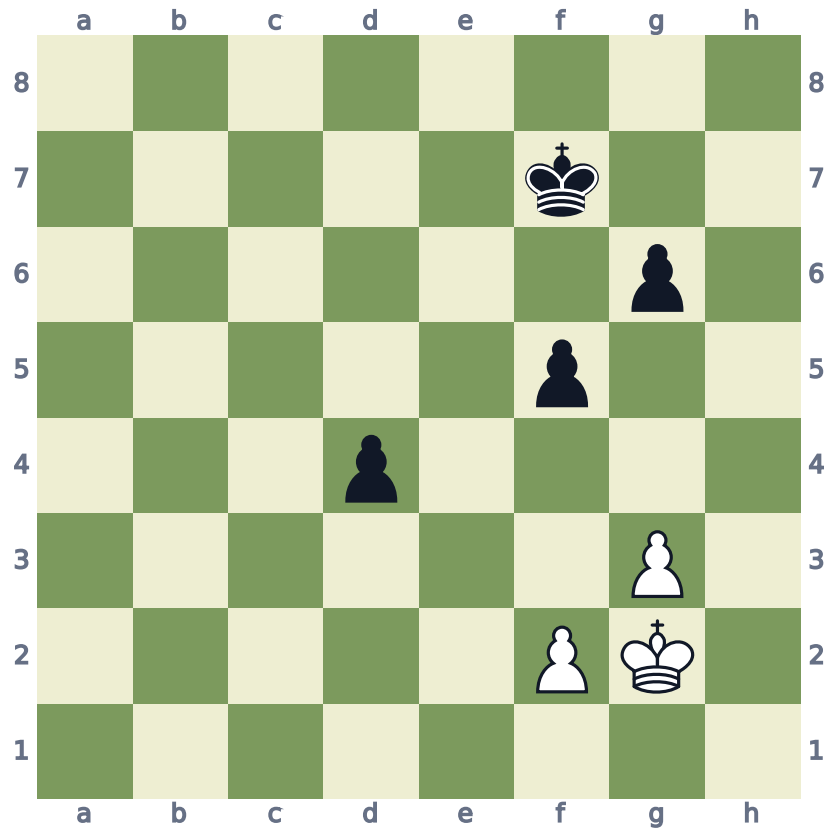
Use opposition to gain or deny entry. The second engine candidate scores +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.00.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 19 OF 32

Outside passed pawn - reverse colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. Ke6 f4 2. Kd5 Kh3 3. Ke4 Kh4 4. d3 Kg5 5. d2 Kxg6

WHY IT WORKS

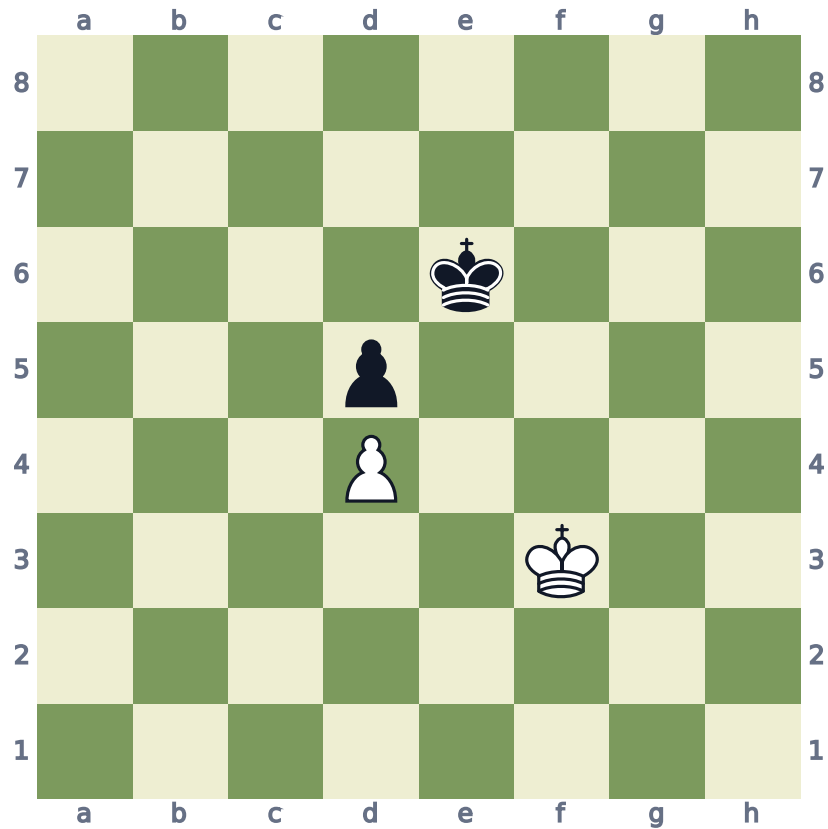
Calculate whether the outside passer distracts the king in time. The second engine candidate scores +5.21 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.59.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +5.80 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 20 OF 32

Reserve tempo - reverse colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kg4 Ke7 2. Kg5 Ke6 3. Kg6 Ke7 4. Kf5 Kd7 5. Ke5 Kc6

WHY IT WORKS

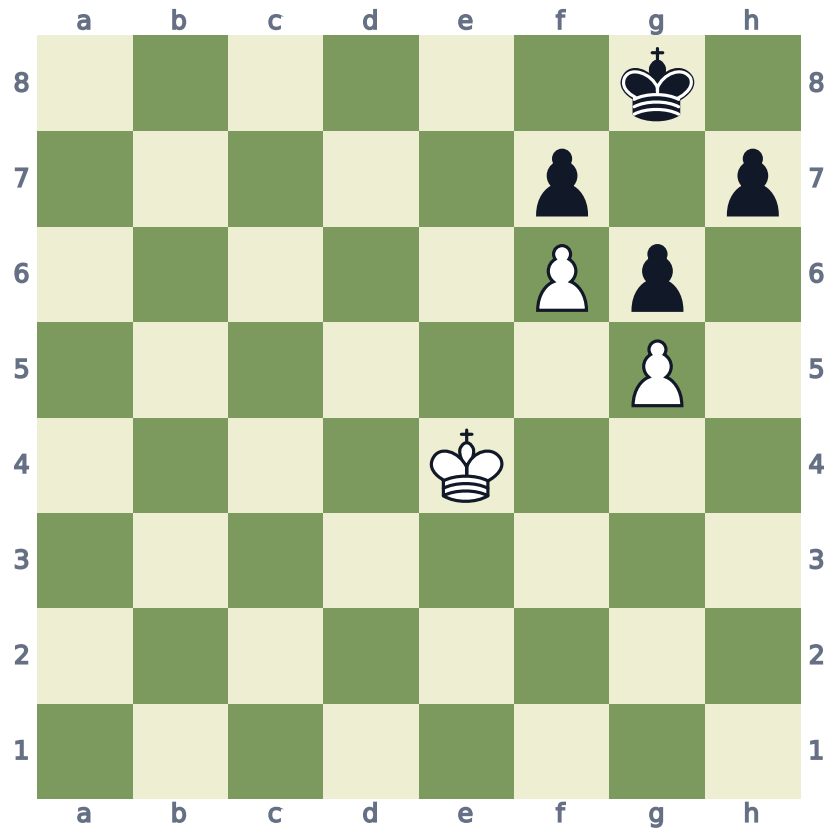
A pawn move can be the final reserve tempo in a zugzwang. The second engine candidate scores +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.20.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +0.20 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 21 OF 32

Pawn breakthrough - reverse colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kf4 Kh8 2. Kg4 h5+ 3. gxh6 Kh7 4. Kg5 Kg8 5. Kh4 Kh7

WHY IT WORKS

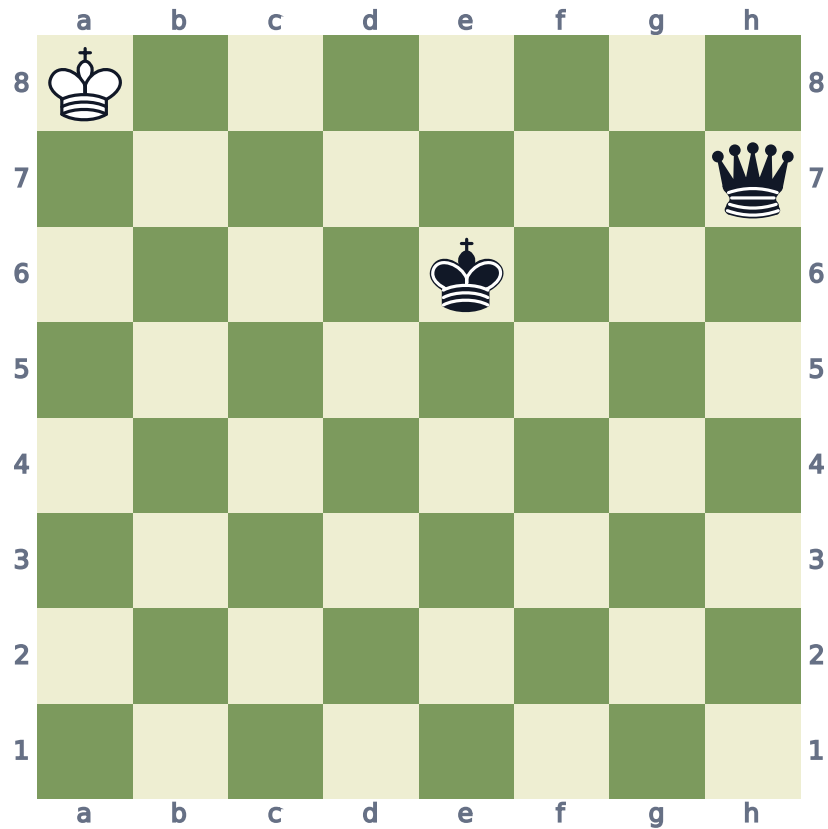
Look for a sacrifice that creates an unstoppable passer. The second engine candidate scores +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.00.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 22 OF 32

Queen mate technique - reverse colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. Ke5 Kb8 2. Kd6 Ka8 3. Kc7 Ka7 4. Qg6 Ka8 5. Qa6#

WHY IT WORKS

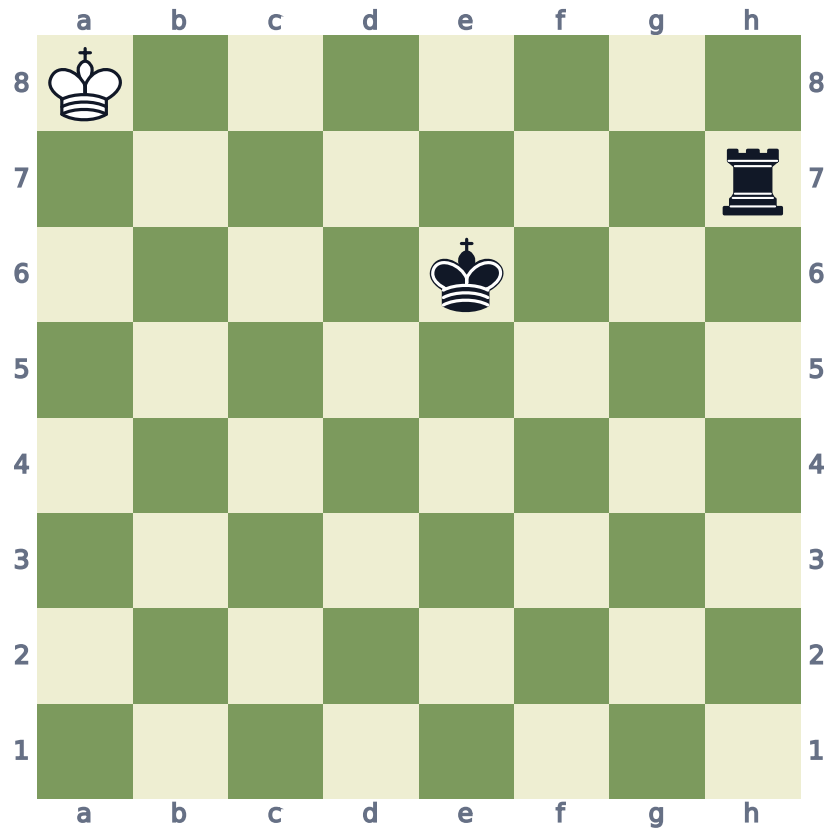
Restrict the king, bring your king, and avoid stalemate. The second engine candidate scores mate in 5; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.00.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: mate in 5.

SOLUTION 23 OF 32

Rook mate technique - reverse colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kd6 Kb8 2. Kc6 Ka8 3. Kc7 Ka7 4. Rh8 Ka6 5. Rh5 Ka7

WHY IT WORKS

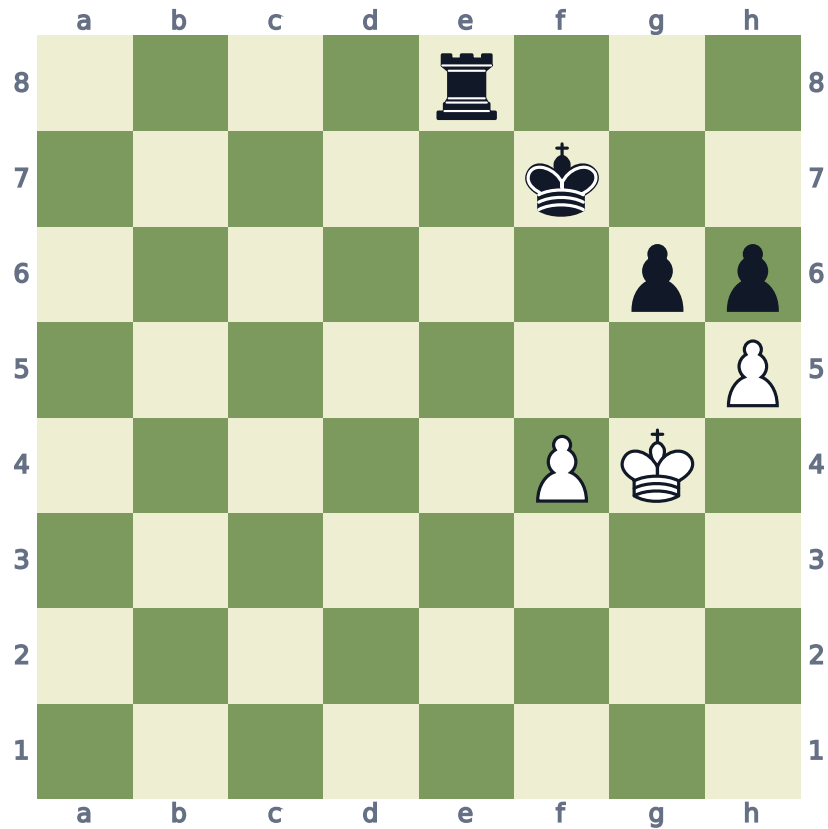
Cut off the king and shrink the box. The second engine candidate scores mate in 6; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.00.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: mate in 6.

SOLUTION 24 OF 32

Rook activity - reverse colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kg7 f5 2. gxh5+ Kxh5 3. Kf6 Kg4 4. Rh8 Kf3 5. Kxf5 Ke3

WHY IT WORKS

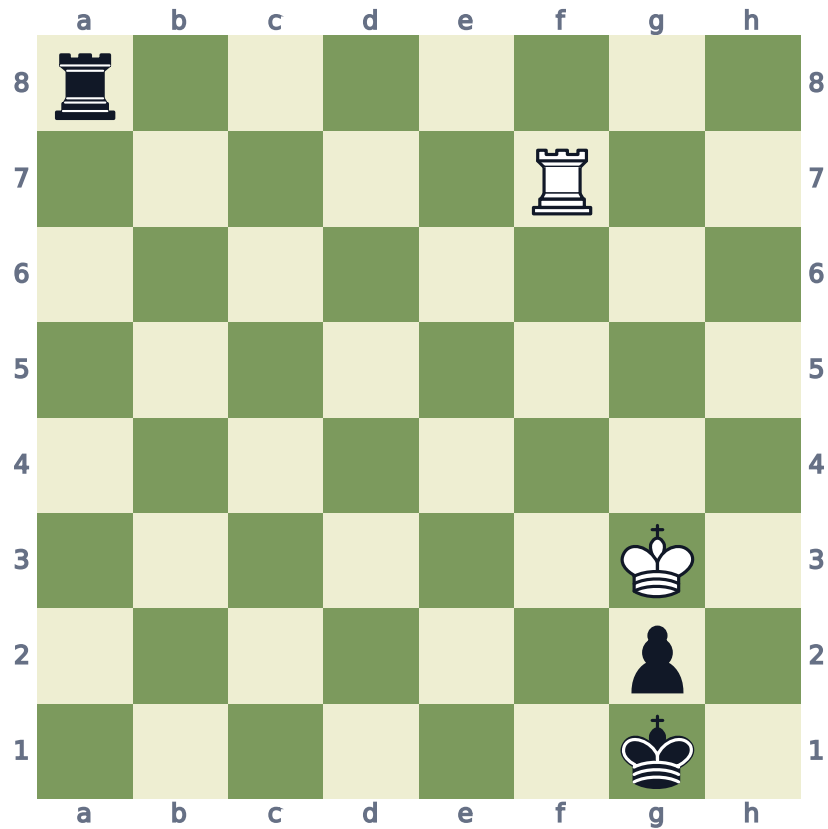
Activate the rook before collecting pawns. The second engine candidate scores +6.34 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 3.04.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +9.38 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 25 OF 32

Lucena bridge - reverse colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. Rh8 Rc7 2. Kh1 Rc1+ 3. g1=Q+ Rxc1+ 4. Kxc1 Kg4 5. Rg8+ Kf5

WHY IT WORKS

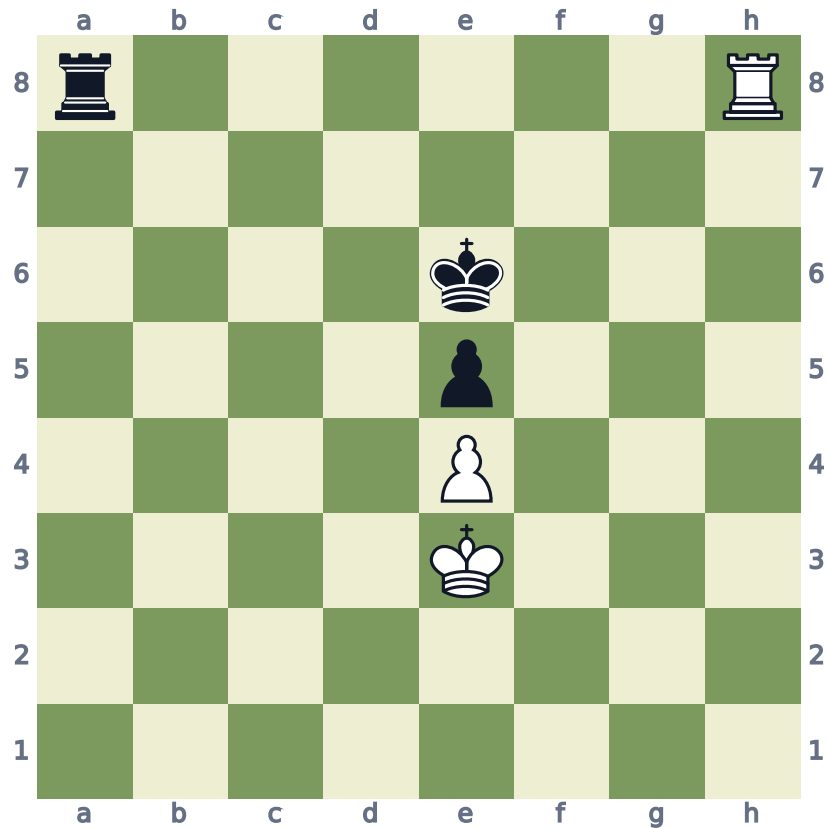
Build a bridge so the king can escape checks and promote. The second engine candidate scores +4.53 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.06.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +4.59 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 26 OF 32

Rook checks from behind - reverse colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. Rxh8 Ke2 2. Kf6 Kf3 3. Kg5 Ke3 4. Rc8 Kf3 5. Rc3+ Ke2

WHY IT WORKS

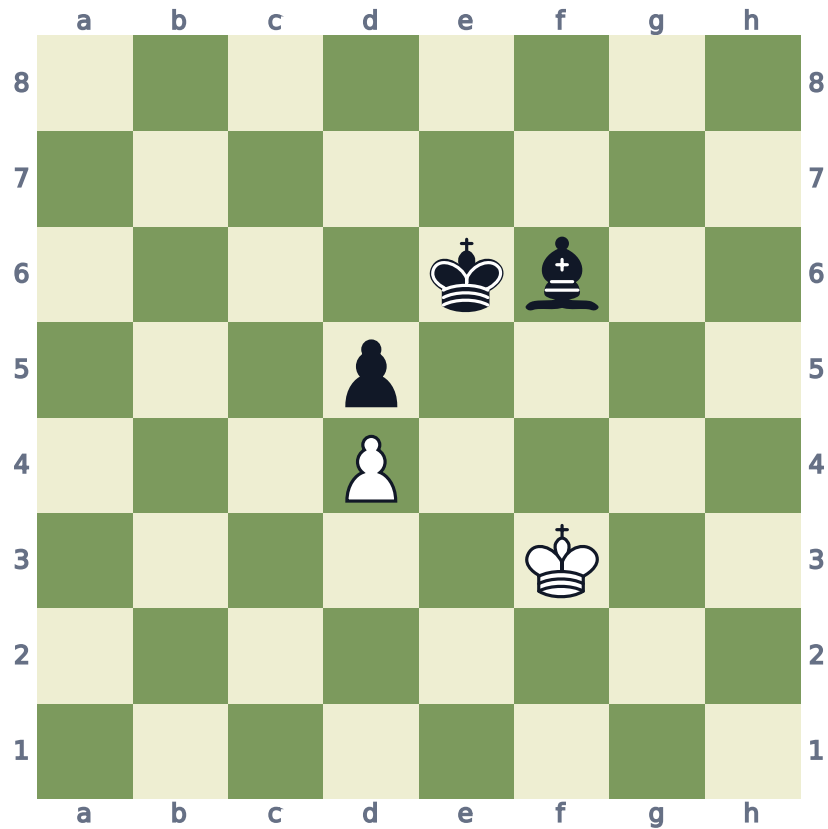
Compare checking distance with passive defense. The second engine candidate scores +0.13 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 11.62.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +11.75 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 27 OF 32

Bishop against pawns - reverse colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. Bxd4 Ke2 2. Bc5 Kd2 3. Ke5 Kd3 4. Bd4 Kc2 5. Ke4 Kd2

WHY IT WORKS

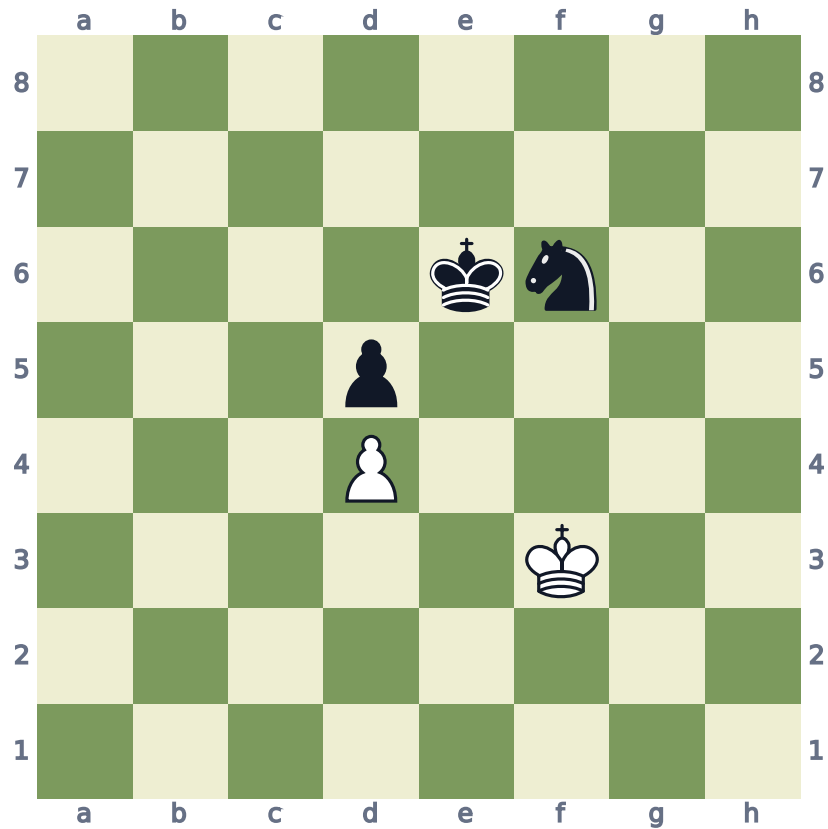
Use the bishop's waiting moves and the king's route. The second engine candidate scores +7.12 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.35.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +7.47 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 28 OF 32

Knight against pawns - reverse colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kf5 Kg3 2. Ne4+ Kh4 3. Nd6 Kg3 4. Nb5 Kf3 5. Nxd4+ Ke3

WHY IT WORKS

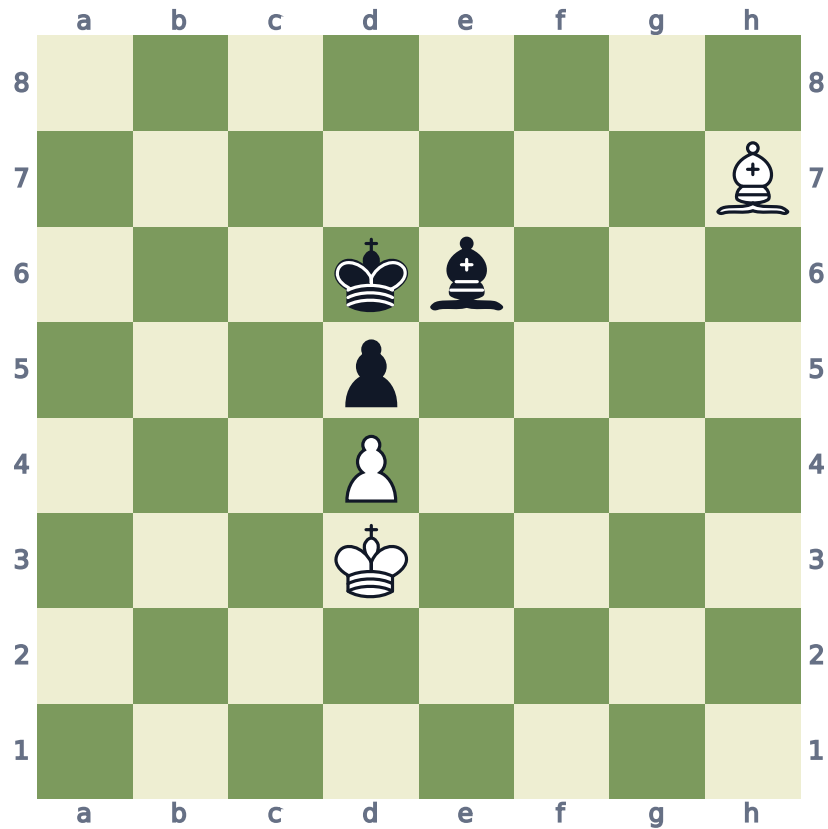
Calculate whether the knight can blockade without losing tempi. The second engine candidate scores +5.23 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.16.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +5.39 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 29 OF 32

Opposite-colored bishops - reverse colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. Bc8 Ke3 2. Ba6 Bf5 3. Bb5 Bg4 4. Bc4 Kf4 5. Bb5 Bf3

WHY IT WORKS

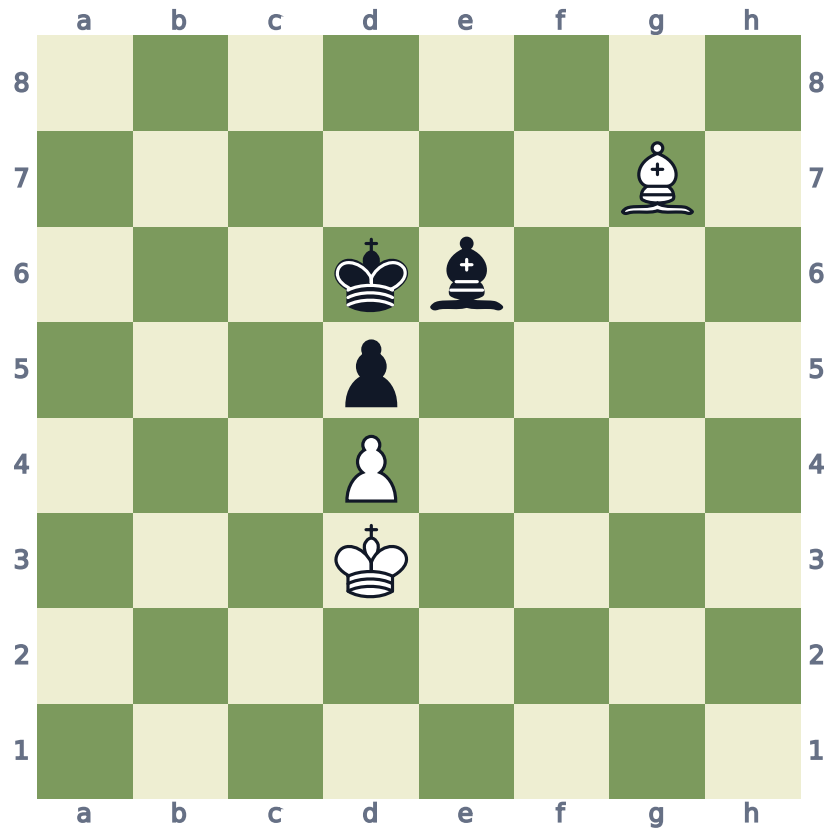
Activity and king entry often matter more than a nominal extra pawn. The second engine candidate scores -0.10 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.01.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -0.09 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 30 OF 32

Same-colored bishops - reverse colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. Bd7 Bh8 2. Ke6 Kc3 3. Bb5 Kb4 4. Bc4 Kc5 5. Ke7 Kb4

WHY IT WORKS

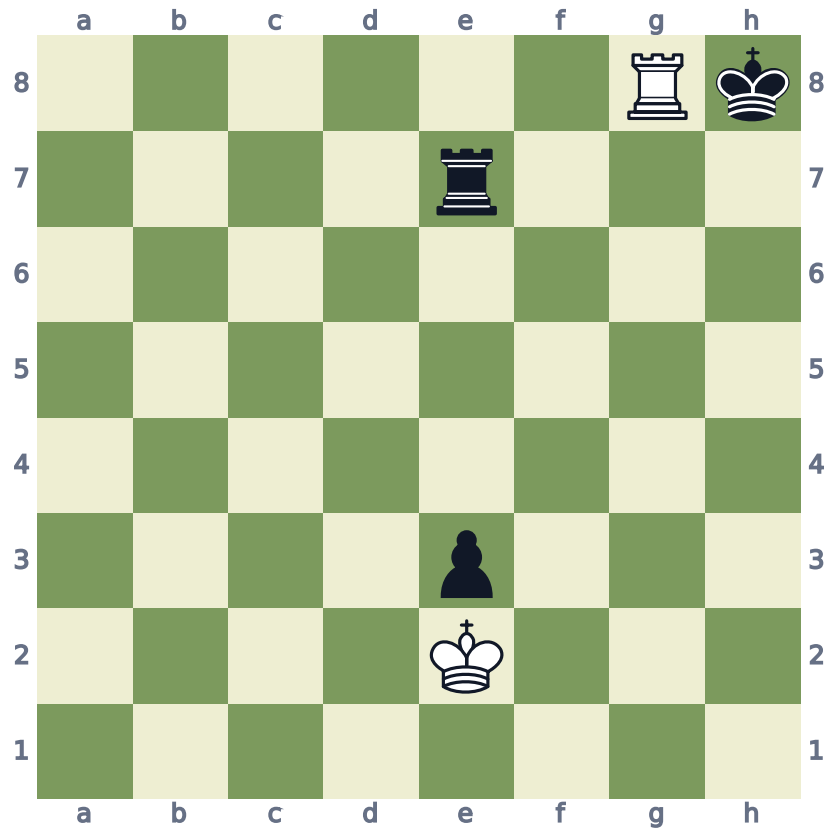
Fight for penetration squares on the shared color complex. The second engine candidate scores +0.01 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.00.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +0.01 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 31 OF 32

Rook behind the passer - reverse colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kxg8 Kd3 2. e2 Kd4 3. e1=Q Kc4 4. Rd7 Kc5 5. Qe6 Kb5

WHY IT WORKS

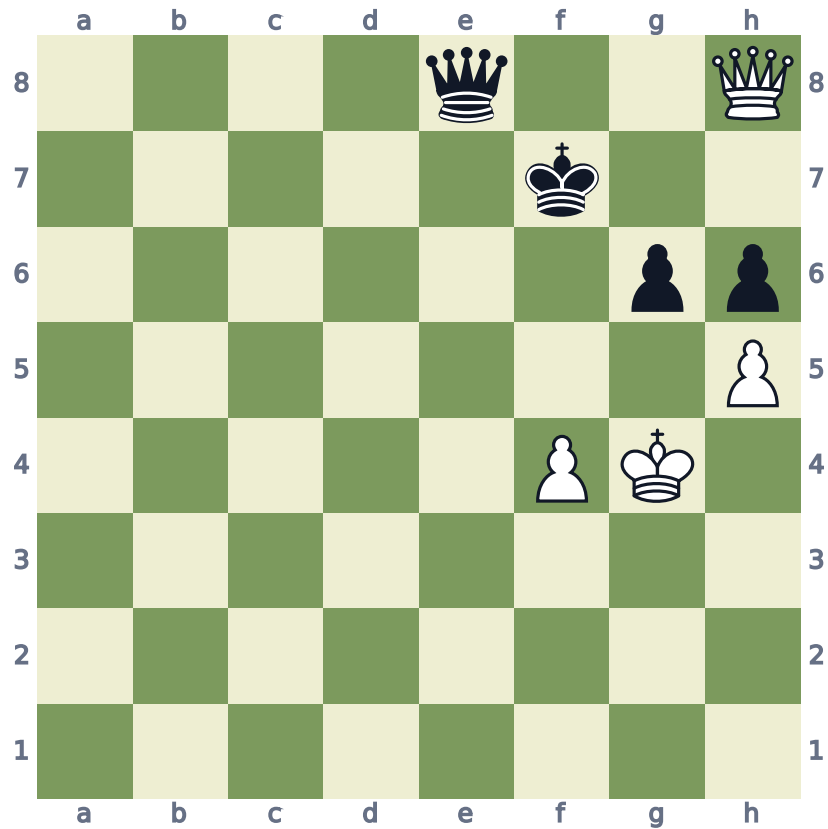
Place the rook behind the pawn and calculate checking resources. The second engine candidate scores -0.14 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 9.20.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +9.06 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 32 OF 32

Queen checks - reverse colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. gxh5+ Kh4 2. Qxh8 Kxh5 3. Kf6 Kg4 4. Qa8 Kg3 5. Kf5 Kf2

WHY IT WORKS

Checks, king exposure, and perpetual possibilities come before pawn counting. The second engine candidate scores +10.82 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.71.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +11.53 from the side-to-move perspective.

REVIEW

Final mixed review

1

Select five missed positions and solve them in random order without motif names.

2

Explain why the best defense fails in each of those positions.

3

Reverse the board and describe whether the same geometry is still easy to recognize.

4

Find one example of the theme in your own game or a Fritz training game.

5

Retest under a shorter clock only after calculation is accurate without time pressure.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Repeat missed positions tomorrow, then after 3, 7, 14, and 30 days. Remove a position only after two correct solutions with a complete explanation.